

Tourism booklet of materials

100 level (Introductory)

TOU1010: THE TOURISM SECTOR
TOU1030: QUALITY GUEST SERVICE
TOU1050: THE ACCOMMODATION INDUSTRY
TOU1060: THE TRAVEL INDUSTRY
TOU1070: THE ATTRACTIONS INDUSTRY
TOU1910: TOU PROJECT A

200 level (Intermediate)

TOU2010: EVENT MANAGEMENT
TOU2060: TRAVEL DESTINATIONS 1
TOU2070: TRAVEL DESTINATIONS 2
TOU2080: TRAVEL PLANNING
TOU2910: TOU PROJECT B
TOU2920: TOU PROJECT C

Course Description

Students interested in careers in travel, hospitality, event planning, or any aspect of the tourism industry. This course is also ideal for those who love exploring different cultures and places. The Exploring the World of Tourism course offers students an exciting introduction to the dynamic and diverse field of tourism. This course is designed to ignite a passion for travel and hospitality, providing students with a broad understanding of the tourism industry, including its history, development, and current trends. Students create and evaluate local, national or international tour packages, including itinerary, cost and attractions information, and traveller information.

Course Objectives

- To understand the significance and impact of tourism on local, national, and global economies and culture.
- To explore various sectors within the tourism industry such as hospitality, travel services, event planning, accommodations, and destination marketing.
- To develop key skills in customer service, communication, professionalism, and cultural sensitivity, essential for a successful career in tourism.
- To analyze the role of sustainable and responsible tourism in preserving cultural, environmental, and natural heritage.
- To gain practical insights through case studies analysis, conversations, and industry professionals.

Units of Study

Students will explore and research introduction to Tourism, Travel Services, Hospitality Management, Event and Recreation Management, Cultural and Eco-Tourism, Tourism Marketing and Promotion, Potential Career Opportunities in Tourism.



Resource Websites

Travel Alberta	https://www.travelalberta.com/
Travel and Tourism Canada	https://travel.gc.ca/
Canadian Tourism	https://www.destinationcanada.com/en
Discover Tourism	https://discovertourism.ca/
Explore Edmonton	https://exploreedmonton.com/
British Columbia Tourism	www.hellobc.com/
Destination Ontario	https://www.destinationontario.com/
Expedia	https://www.expedia.ca/
Travelocity	https://www.travelocity.ca/
Trivago	https://www.trivago.ca/
Tripadvisor	https://www.tripadvisor.ca/

Instructions

This material has been created to enable you to engage in self-study of Tourism. Please follow the steps as identified in this booklet and address any questions to your instructor. Next Step students are required to check in with their instructor(s) weekly. It is recommended that multiple check ins occur each week to ensure successful completion of academic course work. Students not adhering to the weekly check in schedule or failing to engage in the learning process will be removed from their course.

Instructor

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Assessment

- **Formative Assessments:** Integrated into each unit; includes case analyses, scenario exercises, position papers, and research assignments.
- **Summative Assessment:** Comprehensive legal project incorporating elements from all six modules, demonstrating critical understanding and applied skills. Flexible submission options totaling 100 marks.

Students will be assessed through a combination of assignments, research activities, project work, presentations, observations, and focused conversations. Module work may be modified at the discretion of the instructor and after conversation with the student.

Each module is valued and graded out of 100 total marks, based on the key learner outcomes. Additionally, each module is weighted at 100% in the category weights as assignments category. Select elements of module work may be presented orally as approved by the instructor.

Our Next Step vision is to create a community of learners who embody the virtues of acceptance, flexibility, individualization, respect, and responsibility.

TOU1010: THE TOURISM SECTOR

Description: Students analyze the organizational structure of the tourism industry at local, provincial, national and global levels. Students will perform introductory investigations of employment opportunities in tourism.

The tourism sector, with its wide-ranging impact on economic, social, and environmental aspects, typically features a diverse and multi-tiered organizational structure. This structure can be described at various levels:

International Organizations: These include entities like the United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO), which provides guidance, research, and policy support at the global level. They play a role in promoting sustainable and responsible tourism practices worldwide.

National Tourism Boards or Ministries: These are government departments responsible for formulating national tourism policies, promoting tourism, and sometimes regulating the industry. They often work on attracting international tourists and managing national branding.

Regional and Local Tourism Organizations: At a more localized level, these organizations focus on promoting tourism in specific regions, cities, or attractions. They often coordinate with local businesses and stakeholders to develop and market tourism products and experiences relevant to their area.

Private Sector: This includes a wide array of businesses such as travel agencies, tour operators, hospitality providers (hotels, resorts, etc.), transportation services (airlines, cruise lines, etc.), and attraction operators. These entities are primarily responsible for creating and delivering the actual tourism products and experiences.

Trade Associations and Professional Bodies: These organizations, such as the World Travel & Tourism Council (WTTC), represent the interests of private sector players. They often engage in lobbying, industry standard-setting, networking, and providing resources to their members.

Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs): NGOs in tourism may focus on various aspects such as environmental conservation, cultural heritage preservation, or community-based tourism. They often work towards ensuring that tourism development is sustainable and beneficial to local communities and environments.

Educational and Research Institutions: Universities and research organizations contribute to the tourism sector through education, training, and research. They help in developing a skilled workforce and in generating new knowledge and innovations for the industry.

Communities and Indigenous Groups: These stakeholders are crucial as they are directly impacted by tourism activities. Their involvement is essential for sustainable tourism development that respects local cultures and environments.

The terms "industry" and "sector" are often used interchangeably, but they have differences in meaning which can be important in understanding the structure and dynamics of tourism.

Industry:

- The term "industry" typically refers to a group of companies or organizations involved in producing a specific type of goods or services. In the context of tourism, the "tourism industry" would encompass all businesses and organizations directly involved in the production, promotion, or delivery of tourism-related services and experiences.
- This includes hotels, airlines, travel agencies, tour operators, and attraction providers.
- The focus is more on the operational aspect and the commercial entities that make up the tourism offering.
- The tourism industry is often seen as a part of the service industry, given its focus on delivering experiences and services rather than tangible products.

Sector:

- "Sector," on the other hand, is a broader term that refers to a significant segment of the economy. The "tourism sector" encompasses not just the industry players but also the wider economic, social, cultural, and environmental contexts in which tourism operates.
- It includes government bodies, non-profit organizations, local communities, and other stakeholders that contribute to, regulate, or are affected by tourism activities.
- The sector view is more holistic, considering the impact of tourism on the economy, society, and environment, and the role of policy, regulation, and development strategies in shaping tourism.
- The tourism sector is often seen as a subset of the economy, highlighting its role as an economic driver and a field of policy and development focus.

While the tourism industry is about the businesses and organizations that directly provide tourism services and experiences, the tourism sector is a wider concept that includes not only these businesses but also the broader context in which they operate, including regulation, impacts, and stakeholder interactions.

The tourism sector is typically categorized into various industry groups to better understand and manage its diverse components. While the original eight sectors provide a comprehensive view of the different areas within tourism, these can be grouped into five broader industry groups for a more streamlined categorization. Here's how they can be defined and grouped:

Transportation and Travel Trade

Transportation: This includes all modes of travel used by tourists, such as airlines, cruise ships, trains, buses, and car rentals. It's essential for facilitating tourist travel between different destinations and within them.

Travel Trade: This sector comprises travel agents and tour operators who package and sell travel products and services to consumers. They play a crucial role in connecting tourists with various tourism services and often act as intermediaries in the tourism distribution system.

Accommodation. This sector includes all forms of lodging facilities provided to tourists, ranging from hotels and resorts to bed and breakfasts, hostels, and camping sites. Accommodation is a fundamental component of tourism, providing tourists with a place to stay during their travels.

Food and Beverage Services. This sector encompasses all establishments that provide food and drinks to travelers, including restaurants, cafes, bars, and catering services. Food and beverage services are a vital part of the tourist experience, reflecting the local culture and cuisine.

Meetings, Events, and Conferences (MICE). This group includes the organization and hosting of meetings, incentives, conferences, and exhibitions. It's a specialized sector that caters to business travelers and large groups, often involving significant coordination and planning.

Attractions and Recreation (Including Adventure Tourism and Ecotourism)

Attractions: This encompasses natural, cultural, and man-made attractions that draw tourists. Examples include historical sites, museums, national parks, theme parks, and landmarks.

Adventure Tourism, Recreation, and Ecotourism: These sub-sectors focus on outdoor activities and experiences, ranging from adventure sports to wildlife safaris and nature-based activities. Ecotourism emphasizes sustainable, environmentally friendly travel.

Tourism Services. This sector covers a range of services that support the tourism industry, including marketing, information services, education and training, and regulatory bodies. These services are crucial for the smooth operation and growth of the tourism sector.

Each of these industry plays a distinct role in the tourism experience, contributing to the sector's diversity and vibrancy. They are interconnected, and their success depends on the collaboration and coordination among them to provide a seamless and enjoyable experience for tourists.

The tourism sector involves a complex web of organizations operating at local, national, and international levels. Here's an overview:

Local Level

Local Government Authorities:

Develop and implement local tourism policies, provide necessary infrastructure, and ensure sustainable tourism practices. Collaborate with national tourism boards for policy alignment and local businesses to support tourism development.

Local Tourism Associations:

Promote local attractions, organize events, and provide support to local tourism businesses. Work with local government for funding and policy support, and with local businesses for joint marketing efforts.

Private-Sector Operations (e.g., Hotels, Restaurants, Tour Operators):

Offer tourism services and experiences, maintain service quality, and adhere to local tourism policies. Partner with local tourism associations for promotional activities and comply with local government regulations.

National Level

National Tourism Boards or Ministries:

Formulate national tourism policies, market the country as a tourist destination, and coordinate with international organizations. Collaborate with local governments to ensure policy implementation, and with private sectors for national marketing campaigns.

National Industry Associations (e.g., Hotel Associations, Travel Agency Associations):

Represent industry interests, provide member support, and engage in lobbying for favorable policies. Work with tourism ministries for policy advocacy and with businesses for industry standards and training.

International Level

United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO):

Promote responsible, sustainable, and universally accessible tourism; provide guidance and knowledge to the global tourism community. Collaborate with national tourism organizations for global policy development and with NGOs for sustainable tourism initiatives.

World Travel & Tourism Council (WTTC):

Represent the private sector of global travel and tourism, conduct research, and host global events. Engage with national governments and international organizations to influence global tourism policies and trends.

Interaction and Collaboration

- **Public-Private Partnerships:** Collaboration between government entities and private-sector businesses is crucial for developing infrastructure, marketing destinations, and creating tourist packages.
- **Cross-Level Collaboration:** Local, national, and international organizations often work together to align policies, share best practices, and ensure that tourism development is sustainable and beneficial at all levels.
- **Event and Conference Participation:** Organizations across all levels participate in and host events and conferences to network, discuss industry trends, and form partnerships.
- **Policy and Regulation Alignment:** Ensuring that local and national policies align with international guidelines and best practices for maintaining global standards in tourism.

The interaction among these various organizations ensures a cohesive approach to tourism development, addressing issues ranging from local community needs to global tourism trends. Each level of organization plays a unique role, and their effective collaboration is essential for the sustainable growth of the tourism sector.

Required Assignment

/100 Marks

1. Define the following terms: tourism, tourist, outbound, inbound
2. Assess the effects different travel motivators, trends and sustainability have on industry activity
3. Explore the history and development of tourism in Canada
4. Describe and discuss the various visitor characteristics, including: (*geographic, demographic, psychographic, socioeconomic*) that may impact tourism
5. Describe various motivating factors for travel, including: (*leisure, disposable income, educational opportunities, personal interest, business*)
6. Outline any current tourism and travel trends
7. Explore the positive and negative impacts of tourism
8. Explain various societal and political factors that influence tourism industry activity
9. Describe what it means to be a responsible tourist
10. Identify local tourism facilities and services in two different industries
11. Identify different mediums used to promote tourism and describe promotion strategies used to with various populations
12. Research a local promotional tourism strategy and outline its effectiveness

TOU1030: QUALITY GUEST SERVICE

Description: Students demonstrate the knowledge, skills and attitudes of quality guest service, including hospitality, effective communication and workplace safety.

Providing quality guest service in the tourism and hospitality industry is crucial for several reasons, significantly impacting customer satisfaction, loyalty, and the overall success of the business. Key aspects of why quality guest service is so important:

Enhances Customer Satisfaction: Quality service directly contributes to a positive guest experience. Satisfied customers are more likely to enjoy their stay, engage with the services offered, and leave with a positive impression.

Builds Customer Loyalty: When customers receive exceptional service, they are more likely to return in the future and become loyal patrons. This repeat business is often more cost-effective than acquiring new customers.

Promotes Positive Word-of-Mouth: Happy guests are likely to recommend the services to friends and family. In the age of social media and online reviews, positive word-of-mouth can significantly influence the decision-making of potential customers.

Gives Competitive Advantage: In a highly competitive market, quality guest service can be a key differentiator that sets a business apart from its competitors. It can be a crucial factor in a customer's decision to choose one service provider over another.

Drives Revenue Growth: Quality service not only helps in retaining customers but can also lead to increased spending. Satisfied guests are more likely to use additional services or make repeat bookings, thereby boosting revenue.

Reduces Complaints and Negative Reviews: By ensuring that guests are well taken care of, businesses can minimize the occurrence of complaints and negative reviews, which can be damaging to reputation and business prospects.

Enhances Brand Reputation: Consistently delivering high-quality service contributes to a strong brand image and reputation. This reputation is essential for long-term success and can attract not only more customers but also high-quality employees.

Increases Employee Morale and Retention: A focus on quality service often involves empowering employees and creating a positive work environment. This can lead to increased job satisfaction, lower staff turnover, and a more motivated workforce.

Adapts to Customer Expectations and Needs: Quality guest service means being attentive to the changing needs and expectations of guests, which is crucial in a dynamic industry like tourism and hospitality.

Contributes to the Overall Experience: In the tourism and hospitality industry, the experience is the product. Quality service is integral to delivering a memorable and enjoyable experience.

Quality guest service is not just a nice-to-have aspect of the tourism and hospitality industry; it's a vital component that can significantly influence a business's success and reputation.

The concept of the "Four I's" in guest service is a framework used to understand and improve the quality of service in the hospitality and tourism industry. These four components are essential in creating a memorable and satisfying experience for guests.

1. Intangibility:

- **Explanation:** Services in the hospitality industry are intangible; they cannot be touched or seen before they are delivered. This characteristic makes it challenging to evaluate service quality beforehand.
- **Implication in Guest Service:** The intangibility of services means that businesses focus on creating a positive perception through branding, reputation, and consistently delivering high-quality service. It is crucial to manage customer expectations and ensure that the actual experience matches or exceeds those expectations.

2. Inconsistency:

- **Explanation:** Unlike physical products, services are highly variable and dependent on who provides them and when they are provided. This inconsistency can lead to variations in service quality.
- **Implication in Guest Service:** To address inconsistency, it's important to provide thorough training and standard operating procedures for staff. Consistent quality in service delivery can be achieved through regular training, monitoring, and feedback mechanisms. This consistency builds trust and reliability.

3. Inseparability:

- **Explanation:** In hospitality, service delivery and consumption happen simultaneously; the production of the service cannot be separated from its consumption.
- **Implication in Guest Service:** This inseparability means that staff must be adept at managing interactions with guests as these interactions are a core part of the service experience. It also highlights the importance of the human element in service delivery, as the attitude, behavior, and skills of the staff directly impact the quality of the service.

4. Inventory (Perishability):

- **Explanation:** Services are perishable and cannot be stored for future use. For example, an unsold hotel room for a night or an empty seat on a flight represents lost revenue that cannot be regained.
- **Implication in Guest Service:** Effective inventory management is crucial. Businesses need to implement strategic pricing, booking, and cancellation policies

to maximize revenue. They also need to focus on demand forecasting and capacity management to reduce the wastage of perishable service inventory.

Understanding and effectively managing these four I's is crucial for any business in the hospitality and tourism industry to ensure high-quality guest service.

The building blocks of service, often referred to as the foundation upon which effective and efficient service delivery is constructed, are critical in ensuring customer satisfaction and loyalty, especially in service-oriented industries like hospitality, tourism, and retail. These include:

Tangibles: This refers to the physical facilities, equipment, and appearance of personnel. Tangibles are the visible cues that customers often use to make initial judgments about the quality of service they can expect. First impressions are crucial. Well-maintained, clean, and appealing physical settings and professional appearance of staff can significantly influence customer perceptions and trust.

Reliability: Reliability is the ability to perform the promised service dependably and accurately. It means delivering on commitments and providing services as promised to the customers. This is often the most important building block. Consistent reliability builds trust and confidence in the service provider.

Responsiveness: Responsiveness is the willingness to help customers and provide prompt service. It involves attentiveness and promptness in dealing with customer requests, complaints, and problems. Quick and helpful responses can greatly enhance customer satisfaction and demonstrate that a business values its customers.

Assurance: Assurance encompasses the knowledge, courtesy, and ability of employees and their ability to convey trust and confidence. Competent staff who convey a sense of assurance and confidence in their service can significantly influence customer trust and perceptions of quality.

Empathy: Empathy involves caring, individualized attention a company provides to its customers. It reflects the effort to understand and cater to the individual needs and emotions of customers. Demonstrating empathy can lead to stronger customer relationships and a more personalized service experience.

Service Design and Standards: This refers to the design of the service processes and setting clear service standards. It includes the planning of the service delivery process from start to finish. Well-designed service processes and standards ensure consistency and efficiency.

Employee Training and Development: This involves providing employees with the necessary skills and knowledge to perform their roles effectively. Trained and knowledgeable staff are crucial for delivering high-quality service and handling customer interactions competently.

Communication: Effective communication with customers throughout the service process, including listening to their needs and providing clear, helpful information. Good communication helps in managing customer expectations and enhances the overall service experience.

Feedback and Continuous Improvement: This involves gathering customer feedback and using it to make continuous improvements in service delivery. Feedback is essential for understanding customer needs and preferences and for identifying areas of improvement.

Technology Integration: Utilizing technology to enhance service delivery, such as through online booking systems, customer relationship management (CRM) tools, and automated services. Technology can improve efficiency, personalize service, and provide convenience.

These building blocks are interrelated and collectively contribute to the overall quality and effectiveness of service delivery.

Various agencies play crucial roles in developing guest service standards in the hospitality and tourism industry. These standards are essential for ensuring consistent and high-quality experiences for guests. The key agencies involved, and their roles may include:

Government Tourism Departments: These departments often develop guidelines and standards for the tourism industry within their jurisdiction. They may also offer certification programs for hospitality businesses that meet these standards. Example Activities: Setting minimum service standards, inspecting and rating accommodations, and enforcing regulations for safety and quality.

National and International Tourism Organizations: Organizations like the United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO) or national tourism boards develop broad guidelines and best practices for tourism services, which can be adopted globally. Example Activities: Publishing global standards for sustainable tourism, offering training and resources, and promoting quality standards across different countries.

Industry Associations: These include associations for hotels, restaurants, travel agencies, and more. They play a key role in establishing industry-specific service standards and advocating for the interests of their members. Example Activities: Developing best practice guides, providing member training and certification, and setting benchmarks for service excellence.

Quality Assurance and Accreditation Bodies: Organizations like the Canadian Automobile Association (CAA) or Forbes Travel Guide provide independent assessments of hospitality services and award ratings based on predefined standards. Example Activities: Conducting inspections, awarding star or diamond ratings, and offering accreditation to businesses that meet high service standards.

Consumer Advocacy Groups: These groups represent the interests of consumers and can influence service standards by highlighting customer expectations and experiences. Example Activities: Publishing consumer reviews and ratings, advocating for customer rights, and providing feedback to the industry on service quality.

Training and Educational Institutions: Hospitality and tourism schools and training programs are instrumental in shaping the workforce. They embed service standards into their curriculum,

thus educating future industry professionals. Example Activities: Offering courses on customer service, hospitality management, and industry best practices.

Corporate Policies of Individual Companies: Large hospitality companies often set their own high service standards, which can become benchmarks for the industry. Example Activities: Developing company-specific service protocols, training employees in these standards, and conducting internal quality audits.

Certification Programs: Various certification programs provide recognition to businesses that meet certain service quality standards. Example Activities: Offering certifications for environmental sustainability, customer service excellence, or safety standards.

Consultancy Firms: Specialized consultancy firms in the hospitality industry assist businesses in developing and implementing service standards. Example Activities: Conducting service audits, providing customized training, and advising on best practices.

A professional employee handling guest services in the hospitality and tourism industry has a range of responsibilities that are crucial to ensure guest satisfaction and the overall success of the business. These responsibilities include:

Providing Warm and Welcoming Service:

- Greet guests promptly and warmly.
- Maintain a friendly, approachable demeanor.
- Make guests feel valued and respected.

Effective Communication:

- Communicate clearly, courteously, and professionally with guests.
- Listen actively to understand guest needs and preferences.
- Provide accurate information about services, amenities, local attractions, and directions.

Problem Solving and Complaint Handling:

- Address and resolve guest complaints efficiently and professionally.
- Anticipate potential issues and take proactive measures to prevent them.
- Follow up with guests to ensure their issues have been satisfactorily resolved.

Personalized Service:

- Tailor the service experience to individual guest needs and preferences.
- Remember repeat guests and their specific likes or dislikes.
- Offer customized recommendations based on guest interests.

Maintaining Professionalism:

- Uphold high standards of personal appearance and hygiene.
- Adhere to the company's service standards and policies.
- Demonstrate integrity and honesty in all interactions.

Knowledge and Expertise:

- Have thorough knowledge of the establishment's offerings, policies, and procedures.
- Stay informed about events and attractions to provide guests with relevant information.
- Continuously update skills and knowledge through training and self-learning.

Efficiency and Attention to Detail:

- Perform duties efficiently and with attention to detail.
- Ensure all guest-related tasks are completed accurately and in a timely manner.
- Pay attention to small details that can enhance the guest experience.

Collaboration and Teamwork:

- Work effectively as part of a team to deliver excellent guest service.
- Communicate and coordinate with other departments when necessary.
- Support team members and contribute to a positive work environment.

Handling Confidential Information:

- Respect guest privacy and confidentiality.
- Handle sensitive information, such as personal details and payment information, securely and discreetly.

Adaptability and Flexibility:

- Be adaptable in handling unexpected situations and diverse guest needs.
- Show flexibility in job duties and working hours, especially during peak times.

Cultural Sensitivity:

- Be respectful and sensitive to cultural differences.
- Accommodate special requests that may be culturally significant.

Promoting Additional Services:

- Inform guests about additional services or promotions that may enhance their experience.
- Upsell services appropriately and tactfully.

A professional employee in guest services acts as the face of the establishment, embodying its values and standards.

Creating and maintaining a favorable business reputation through guest service strategies is crucial in the hospitality and tourism industry. The reputation of a business significantly impacts customer decisions and loyalty. Here are key guest service strategies that can help in this regard:

Personalized Service: Tailor services to meet the specific needs and preferences of each guest. This could involve remembering returning customers' preferences, addressing them by name, or customizing their experience based on prior feedback. Personalization makes guests feel valued and recognized, enhancing their overall experience and perception of the business.

Consistently High-Quality Service: Ensure that every aspect of the service, from initial contact to post-departure, is of high quality and consistent across all touchpoints. Consistency builds trust and reliability in the eyes of guests, which is fundamental for a positive reputation.

Proactive Problem Resolution: Train staff to identify and resolve potential issues before they escalate. Encourage proactive communication and empower employees to make decisions that favor guest satisfaction. Effective problem resolution can turn a negative experience into a positive one, often leading to greater guest appreciation and loyalty.

Engaging and Training Staff: Invest in regular training for staff to ensure they are skilled in customer service and familiar with the company's service standards and values. Well-trained and engaged employees are more likely to provide exceptional service, directly influencing guest satisfaction and the business' reputation.

Seeking and Acting on Feedback: Actively seek guest feedback through surveys, comment cards, or online platforms. Importantly, show that the business values this feedback by acting on it and making visible improvements. Demonstrating responsiveness to feedback shows guests that their opinions are valued and that the business is committed to continuous improvement.

Leveraging Technology for Enhanced Experience: Utilize technology such as CRM systems, mobile apps, or AI chatbots to enhance guest interactions and streamline service delivery. Technology can improve efficiency, personalize service, and provide convenience, leading to a more modern and positive guest experience.

Effective Communication: Maintain clear and open communication channels with guests. This includes providing accurate information, responding promptly to inquiries, and being transparent in policies and procedures. Effective communication builds trust and reduce misunderstandings, which is crucial for a positive reputation.

Building a Strong Online Presence: Actively manage online reviews and social media interactions. Respond professionally to both positive and negative reviews. A positive online presence can significantly influence potential customers and enhance the business's reputation.

Community Involvement and Social Responsibility: Engage in community projects or adopt sustainable practices. Share these efforts with guests and stakeholders. Demonstrating social responsibility can enhance the business's image, showing that it cares.

Loyalty Programs and Incentives: Implement loyalty programs or offer incentives for repeat business and referrals. Loyalty programs encourage repeat visits and word-of-mouth promotion, both of which are beneficial for maintaining a favorable reputation.

Effective communication and problem-solving are not just about resolving issues; they are about creating a positive, memorable experience that guests associate with the tourism brand. These skills are essential in ensuring guest satisfaction, loyalty, and the sustainable success of the tourism industry.

Required Assignment**/100 Marks**

1. Identify the importance of ‘professional culture’ as it relates to quality service and of providing quality hospitality and guest service
2. Describe the importance of creating a positive first impression and identify techniques for developing a positive relationship with guests
3. List key professional guest relation skills for employees
4. Briefly define the following as they relate specifically to quality guest service: (*ProServe*, “*Duty to Accommodate*”, *Food Safe Certification*, *Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System (WHMIS)*, *Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FOIP)*, *Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPED)*)
5. Explain how unsafe conditions can negatively impact quality guest service and identify potential hazards with suggested precautions for avoiding them
6. List the legal rights and responsibilities related to guest service and hospitality for maintaining the safety of self and others for: *customers, co-workers, general public*
7. Analyze an industry’s (individual business) policy pertaining to safety and security, including: *employee apparel, lifting, pushing and pulling, electrical, traffic patterns, clean-up and maintenance, emergency evacuation/illness/injury, waste management*
8. List effective listening, speaking and writing strategies for quality guest services
9. Discuss appropriate use of technology in the workplace; *e.g., texting, e-mail, video, use of cell phone*
10. Identify appropriate skills and strategies for communicating with guests and/or guest concerns; *e.g., young children, special needs, diverse cultures, language barriers*
11. Describe the ways employees promote quality guest service and demonstrate characteristics of a professional attitude; *e.g., front desk, room service*
12. Explain the importance of each employee having a high level of knowledge of product and property; *e.g., history of facility, directions to local establishments, history of area*

TOU1050: THE ACCOMMODATION INDUSTRY

Description: Students research accommodation options available, discuss basic principles of the accommodations industry and develop service strategies for handling individual guest requirements.

Market segmentation in the accommodations industry involves dividing a broad consumer or business market, typically consisting of existing and potential customers, into sub-groups of consumers (known as segments) based on some type of shared characteristics. This approach is used to tailor products, services, and marketing strategies to meet the specific needs of different groups more effectively. In the accommodations industry, this segmentation is particularly important due to the diverse needs and preferences of travelers. Key types include:

Geographic Segmentation: Dividing the market based on geographic areas such as countries, cities, regions, or neighborhoods. For example, a hotel chain might offer different services in urban hotels versus those in resort locations.

Demographic Segmentation: Segmenting the market based on demographic variables such as age, gender, family size, income, occupation, education, or nationality. For instance, luxury hotels may target higher income brackets, while hostels may target younger travelers or students.

Psychographic Segmentation: This involves dividing the market based on social class, lifestyle, or personality characteristics. A boutique hotel might appeal to guests valuing exclusivity and unique experiences, whereas a budget hotel chain might attract cost-conscious travelers.

Behavioral Segmentation: Segmenting based on behaviors and patterns such as purchasing occasions, benefits sought, user status, usage rate, loyalty status, and readiness stage. For example, some hotels might focus on frequent business travelers, offering loyalty programs and business-centric amenities.

Purpose of Travel: Dividing the market based on the purpose of travel, such as business, leisure, family vacation, event-based travel (weddings, conferences), or adventure tourism. Accommodations can tailor their offerings based on the primary purpose of their guests' visits, like providing conference rooms for business travelers or family-friendly activities.

Price Sensitivity: Segmenting the market based on customers' sensitivity to price. This can range from budget accommodations for price-sensitive travelers to luxury hotels for those who prioritize experience over cost.

Cultural and Ethnic Background: Focusing on specific cultural or ethnic groups, which can influence travel patterns and accommodation preferences. Some accommodations might cater to specific cultural needs in terms of food, language support, or religious practices.

Special Needs or Accessibility Requirements: Segmenting the market based on guests with special needs or disabilities. Providing accessible rooms and facilities for guests with physical disabilities is an example of this segmentation.

By understanding and effectively applying these market segmentation strategies, accommodation providers can more accurately target and fulfill the diverse needs of their customer base, leading to enhanced guest satisfaction, loyalty, and ultimately, business success.

"Branding" in the accommodations industry refers to the process of creating a unique identity, image, and value proposition for a hotel or lodging business that distinguishes it from its competitors. It involves not just the visual elements like logos and design themes, but also the experiences, perceptions, and emotional responses that guests associate with the brand. Effective branding is essential in the highly competitive accommodations market for several reasons:

Differentiation: Branding helps to set an accommodation apart from others in the market. This can be through a unique theme, superior service, special amenities, or a particular ambiance. It's about creating a distinctive identity that appeals to the target market.

Guest Expectations and Experience: A strong brand communicates what guests can expect before they even make a booking. This includes the level of service, the type of accommodations, the price range, and the overall guest experience.

Emotional Connection: Successful branding in the accommodations industry often involves creating an emotional connection with guests. This could be through a sense of luxury, comfort, adventure, or even a feeling of being at home.

Loyalty and Repeat Business: A strong brand can foster guest loyalty, leading to repeat business. When guests have a positive experience that aligns with the brand promise, they are more likely to return and to recommend the accommodation to others.

Premium Pricing: Effective branding can allow an accommodation to charge premium prices. A well-established brand that is associated with quality, reliability, or luxury can justify higher rates than unbranded or generic competitors.

Marketing Efficiency: A clear and strong brand makes marketing efforts more efficient. It provides a clear framework for promotional activities and helps in targeting the right audience.

Expansion and Franchising: For hotel chains, branding is crucial for expansion and franchising. A consistent brand across different locations ensures that guests have a uniform experience, which is key to the chain's reputation and growth.

Adaptation to Market Changes: A well-established brand can adapt more easily to market changes and guest preferences. It can leverage its brand equity to expand into new markets or to adjust its offerings.

Online Presence and Reputation: In the digital age, branding extends to online presence, including websites, social media, and online reviews. A strong online brand image can significantly influence booking decisions.

Global Recognition: For international hotel chains, branding is essential for global recognition. A universally recognized brand can attract international travelers and gain a foothold in different markets around the world.

Accommodation options in Canada, offer a diverse range of choices to travelers, catering to different preferences and needs. These can be classified based on various factors such as price, location, configuration, and category:

Price:

- **Budget Accommodations:** Includes hostels, budget hotels, motels, and campgrounds. Examples are HI-Hostels in Banff or Jasper, and various motels along major highways.
- **Mid-Range Accommodations:** Comprises three-star and some four-star hotels, bed and breakfasts, and guesthouses. Examples might include chain hotels like Holiday Inn or Best Western, and local B&Bs.
- **Luxury Accommodations:** Includes high-end hotels and resorts, luxury lodges, and boutique hotels. Examples are the Fairmont Banff Springs or the Jasper Park Lodge.

Location:

- **Urban Accommodations:** Located in cities like Edmonton or Calgary, offering easy access to urban attractions, dining, and entertainment.
- **Mountain and National Park Accommodations:** In areas like Banff and Jasper, catering to outdoor enthusiasts and nature lovers.
- **Rural and Countryside Accommodations:** Such as ranches, farm stays, and country inns, offering a more secluded and authentic Alberta experience.

Configuration:

- **Single Rooms and Suites:** Common in hotels and motels, ranging from basic to luxurious.
- **Cabins and Cottages:** Offering more privacy and often located in scenic areas, ideal for families and groups.
- **Hostel Dormitories:** Providing budget-friendly shared accommodations, often preferred by solo travelers and backpackers.
- **RV Parks and Campgrounds:** For travelers with RVs or tents, located throughout Alberta, including in national parks.

Category:

- **Hotels and Resorts:** From budget chains to luxury resorts, catering to a wide range of travelers.
- **Bed and Breakfasts (B&Bs):** Offering a more personalized and cozy experience, often in unique or historic homes.
- **Boutique Hotels:** Smaller hotels with unique themes and personalized service.
- **Vacation Rentals:** Such as Airbnb or VRBO listings, offering a home-like experience.
- **Eco-Lodges and Wilderness Retreats:** Focused on sustainability and immersion in natural settings.
- **Heritage Properties:** Historic properties converted into accommodations, offering a unique historical experience.

An understanding of business operations in the accommodations industry involves several key components. These work together to ensure the efficient and profitable running of accommodations such as hotels, resorts, bed and breakfasts, and other facilities. An overview:

Front Office Operations:

- Check-in and Check-out Procedures: Managing guest arrivals and departures efficiently.
- Reservation Management: Handling bookings, cancellations, and modifications, often using a Property Management System (PMS).
- Guest Services: Providing information, handling requests, and solving guest issues.
- Room Assignment and Management: Ensuring rooms are appropriately assigned based on guest preferences and availability.

Housekeeping and Maintenance:

- Room and Facility Cleaning: Ensuring cleanliness and hygiene in guest rooms and public areas.
- Maintenance Tasks: Regular maintenance and repair of facilities and equipment to ensure safety and functionality.
- Laundry Services: Managing linens, towels, and laundry services for guests.

Food and Beverage Services:

- Dining Options: Operating onsite restaurants, cafes, or bars.
- Room Service: Providing in-room dining services.
- Catering Services: Managing event-related food and beverage services, if applicable.

Financial Management:

- Revenue Management: Strategically setting room rates and managing occupancy to maximize revenue.
- Budgeting and Cost Control: Managing operational budgets, controlling costs, and financial reporting.
- Billing and Payment Processing: Handling guest billing, payment collection, and financial transactions.

Sales and Marketing:

- Promotion and Advertising: Marketing the property through various channels.
- Relationship Management: Building and maintaining relationships with corporate clients, travel agents, and event planners.
- Online Presence: Managing the property's website, online booking platforms, and social media.

Human Resources Management:

- Staffing: Hiring and training staff for various departments.
- Employee Scheduling: Managing staff schedules to ensure adequate coverage.
- Performance Management: Overseeing staff performance and providing training and development opportunities.

Guest Experience Management:

- Customer Service: Providing high-quality service to enhance guest satisfaction.
- Feedback and Reviews: Collecting and responding to guest feedback and online reviews.
- Loyalty Programs: Developing and managing guest loyalty programs.

Compliance and Safety:

- Legal Compliance: Adhering to industry regulations, licensing, and legal requirements.
- Safety and Security: Implementing and maintaining safety and security measures for guests and staff.

Sustainability Initiatives:

- Eco-Friendly Practices: Implementing sustainable practices in operations to minimize environmental impact.

Technology Integration:

- Tech in Operations: Using technology for efficient operations, including PMS, online booking systems, and guest service apps.

Various rating systems are used within the accommodations industry to help guests make informed decisions about where to stay. These systems evaluate accommodations based on a range of criteria, including service quality, amenities, room standard, and overall experience.

Guidebook Ratings: Guidebooks often have their own rating systems, typically based on the inspection and evaluation of hotels and other accommodations. Examples include the AAA (American Automobile Association) Diamond Rating and the Forbes Travel Guide Star Ratings. These ratings usually range from one to five stars or diamonds, with more stars indicating higher levels of luxury and service.

Hotel Critics: Professional hotel critics or travel journalists may rate accommodations based on their personal inspections and experiences. Their ratings and reviews are often published in travel magazines, newspapers, or specialized travel guides. The criteria used by critics can be subjective and may include aspects like ambiance, uniqueness, and personal service quality.

Online Travel Websites: Websites like TripAdvisor, Booking.com, and Expedia feature user-generated ratings and reviews. These ratings are based on guest experiences and can provide a broad range of opinions and insights. Accommodations are typically rated on a scale (e.g., 1 to 10 or 1 to 5 stars), and these platforms may also provide aggregated scores.

Canada Select Accommodations Rating Program: Canada Select is a consumer-driven rating program specific to Canada, which rates accommodations on a scale from one to five stars. It evaluates properties based on quality, state of repair, cleanliness, comfort, and amenities. The program is designed to give travelers a consistent standard of quality within each star rating.

Government-Sponsored Rating Systems: Some countries have official rating systems sponsored or endorsed by the government or tourism boards. For example, the Hotelstars Union in Europe provides a harmonized rating system in participating countries.

Industry-Specific Awards: Various industry-specific awards also serve as informal rating systems. These include accolades like the Condé Nast Traveler's Readers' Choice Awards or the Travel + Leisure World's Best Awards.

Sustainability and Eco-Friendly Ratings: With growing awareness of environmental issues, there are also ratings for eco-friendliness and sustainability, such as the Green Key or EarthCheck certifications.

The accommodations industry has increasingly embraced environmentally responsible practices, recognizing the importance of sustainability in their operations. Key areas where environmentally responsible practices are demonstrated include:

Energy Efficiency:

- **Use of Renewable Energy:** Implementing solar panels or wind energy systems to reduce reliance on non-renewable energy sources.
- **Energy-Efficient Lighting and Appliances:** Using LED lighting, Energy Star-rated appliances, and motion sensors to reduce energy consumption.
- **Smart Thermostats and HVAC Systems:** Installing programmable thermostats and efficient heating, ventilation, and air conditioning systems to optimize energy use.

Water Conservation:

- **Low-Flow Fixtures:** Low-flow showerheads, faucets, and toilets to reduce water usage.
- **Water Recycling Systems:** Implementing greywater systems to recycle water for landscaping or flushing toilets.
- **Linen and Towel Reuse Programs:** Encouraging guests to reuse towels and linens to reduce water and energy used in laundry.

Waste Reduction and Disposal:

- **Composting and Food Waste Management:** Composting organic waste and minimizing food waste through careful planning and donation programs.
- **Recycling Programs:** Providing bins and encouraging guests and staff to recycle.
- **Reducing Single-Use Plastics:** Eliminating or reducing the use of single-use plastics like straws, bottles, and toiletry containers.

Sustainable Sourcing:

- **Locally Sourced and Organic Food:** Using locally sourced, organic, and sustainably produced food items in restaurants and catering.
- **Eco-Friendly Products:** Purchasing environmentally friendly cleaning products.
- **Sustainable Building Materials:** Using sustainable or recycled materials in construction and renovation.

Eco-Certification and Participation in Green Programs:

- **Eco-Certifications:** Obtaining certifications like LEED (Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design), Green Key, or EarthCheck.

- Participation in Environmental Programs: Joining global or local environmental initiatives and programs focused on sustainability in the hospitality industry.

Guest Involvement and Education:

- Educational Programs for Guests: Providing information about the property's sustainability initiatives and how guests can participate.
- Promoting Eco-Friendly Activities: Offering or promoting activities that have minimal environmental impact, such as nature walks, bike rentals, or eco-tours.

Sustainable Transportation Options:

- Encouraging Public Transport and Biking: Providing information or discounts for public transportation, setting up bike rental services, or offering shuttle services.
- Electric Vehicle Charging Stations: Installing EV charging stations for guests with electric vehicles.

Protection of Local Ecosystems:

- Responsible Landscaping: Using native plants in landscaping to support local biodiversity and reduce water consumption.
- Wildlife Protection Measures: Implementing measures to protect local wildlife, such as avoiding harmful chemicals in gardening or participating in habitat conservation efforts.

Ensuring the safety and security of guests is paramount in the accommodations industry, regardless of the type or size of the facility. A range of strategies can be employed to manage these aspects effectively:

Comprehensive Security Measures:

- Surveillance Systems: Install CCTV cameras in common areas and entrances without compromising guest privacy.
- Security Personnel: Employ trained security staff for patrolling and monitoring purposes, especially in larger hotels or resorts.
- Access Control: Use electronic key cards for guest rooms and restrict access to guest-only areas.

Safety Equipment and Protocols:

- Fire Safety: Ensure proper installation and maintenance of smoke detectors, fire extinguishers, and sprinkler systems. Conduct fire drills and clearly mark fire exits.
- Emergency Procedures: Develop and communicate clear emergency response plans for situations like fires, natural disasters, or medical emergencies.

Regular Maintenance and Inspections:

- Facility Checks: Regularly inspect and maintain all areas of the accommodation for potential hazards (e.g., loose carpeting, poor lighting).
- Elevator and Equipment Safety: Ensure regular maintenance of elevators, boilers, HVAC systems, and other critical equipment.

Staff Training and Awareness:

- **Safety Training:** Train staff in emergency procedures, basic first aid, fire safety, and handling security incidents.
- **Guest Awareness:** Educate staff to be vigilant and report any suspicious activities or safety concerns.

Guest Communication and Information:

- **Safety Information in Rooms:** Provide information on emergency exits, safety procedures, and emergency numbers in guest rooms.
- **Front Desk Briefing:** Inform guests about safety measures and protocols during check-in.

Data Security:

- **Personal Information Protection:** Safeguard guests' personal data through secure data management systems.
- **Cybersecurity Measures:** Protect online booking systems and guest Wi-Fi networks from cyber threats.

Health and Environmental Safety:

- **Cleanliness and Hygiene:** Maintain high standards of cleanliness to ensure guest health, including air quality and water safety.
- **Food Safety:** If food services are offered, adhere to strict food safety standards to prevent foodborne illnesses.

Child Safety:

- **Family-Friendly Measures:** For family-oriented facilities, implement child safety measures like pool guards, childproofing rooms, and offering cribs or high chairs.

Special Needs and Accessibility:

- **Accessible Facilities:** Ensure that accommodations are accessible and safe for guests with disabilities, including ramps, handrails, and visual fire alarms.

Partnerships with Local Authorities:

- **Collaboration with Local Services:** Work closely with local police, fire departments, and medical facilities for quick response in emergencies.

Monitoring Guest Behavior:

- **Policy Enforcement:** Enforce policies regarding noise, partying, or other behaviors that could affect the safety and comfort of other guests.

Meeting individual guest requirements and maintaining their well-being are critical aspects of service in the hospitality industry. To ensure guests have a comfortable, enjoyable, and personalized experience, various strategies can be implemented:

Personalized Service:

- **Guest Profiling:** Collect information about guest preferences before or during check-in (e.g., dietary needs, allergies, special occasions).

- Customized Experiences: Tailor services to individual preferences, such as room customization, personalized dining options, or activity recommendations.

Effective Communication:

- Active Listening and Responsiveness: Engage in active listening to understand guest needs and respond promptly and effectively.
- Multilingual Staff: Employ staff who can speak multiple languages to assist guests from diverse backgrounds.
- Clear Signage and Information: Provide clear, accessible information about facilities, services, and local attractions.

Accessibility and Inclusivity:

- Accessible Facilities: Ensure that accommodation and services are accessible to guests with disabilities, including wheelchair-accessible rooms, ramps, and visual aids.
- Inclusive Services: Cater to diverse cultural, religious, and lifestyle needs, respecting different customs and practices.

Health and Wellness:

- Wellness Amenities: Offer wellness amenities such as gyms, spas, yoga classes, or healthy dining options.
- Mental Health Considerations: Create a calming and stress-free environment; offer activities or services focused on relaxation and mental well-being.

Quality and Comfort:

- High-Quality Amenities: Provide quality in-room amenities like comfortable bedding, effective climate control, and quality toiletries.
- Noise Control: Implement measures to reduce noise and disturbances, ensuring a peaceful environment for guests.

Safety and Security:

- Safety Measures: Prioritize guest safety with measures like 24/7 security, in-room safes, and surveillance in common areas.
- Emergency Preparedness: Have clear procedures for handling emergencies, and ensure staff are trained to assist guests in such situations.

Flexibility and Adaptability:

- Flexible Policies: Implement flexible booking and cancellation policies to accommodate unexpected changes in guest plans.
- Adapting to Feedback: Be receptive to guest feedback and willing to make adjustments to services and facilities as needed.

Use of Technology:

- Digital Convenience: Offer digital services like online check-in/check-out, mobile apps for room service, and chatbots for customer service inquiries.

- **Tech Amenities:** Provide high-speed internet, charging stations, and smart room technology for convenience.

Continuous Staff Training: Regular Training: Provide ongoing training to staff on customer service excellence, cultural sensitivity, and handling special requests or needs.

Voluntary designations in the accommodations industry are programs that properties can choose to participate in to demonstrate their adherence to certain standards or focus areas. These designations are often used as a marketing tool to attract specific types of guests or to showcase the property's commitment to particular values or quality standards. Here are some examples:

Approved Accommodation Guide: This typically refers to a guide or listing that includes accommodations that have been inspected and meet certain standards of quality and service. Properties listed are often seen as reputable choices for travelers. **Significance:** Being part of an approved accommodation guide helps properties gain visibility and credibility. It assures guests of a certain level of quality and reliability.

Green Key Eco-Rating Program: A voluntary eco-label awarded to hotels, motels, and resorts that are committed to improving their environmental and fiscal performance. It is based on a self-assessment and verified by an onsite inspection. **Significance:** Participation in this program demonstrates a property's commitment to environmental sustainability. It appeals to eco-conscious travelers and can help reduce operational costs through sustainable practices.

Canada Select: Canada Select is an accommodations rating program that uses a “star” rating system. Properties are assessed based on standards of comfort, facilities, and services. **Significance:** This designation helps guests understand the level of quality they can expect from an accommodation. It provides a reliable standard for comparing properties.

Pets Can Stay: This is a certification for pet-friendly accommodations. Properties that are certified as “Pets Can Stay” ensure that they have facilities and policies in place to comfortably accommodate guests with pets. **Significance:** For travelers who wish to bring their pets along, this designation is crucial. It helps them easily identify accommodations that will cater to their needs, enhancing their travel experience.

Additional Examples:

- **AAA/CAA Diamond Ratings:** Used primarily in North America, this rating system assesses cleanliness, comfort, security, and hospitality.
- **Forbes Travel Guide Star Ratings:** An international rating system for luxury hotels, restaurants, and spas, focusing on high-quality service and facilities.
- **LEED Certification:** Recognizes buildings that are designed and built using strategies aimed at achieving high performance in key areas of human and environmental health.
- **TripAdvisor's GreenLeaders Program:** Showcases a variety of eco-friendly hotels and B&Bs, from budget to luxury.

Required Assignment

/100 Marks

1. List factors that determine the price structure for accommodation properties
2. Define and explain the importance of *occupancy rate* and *average room rate*
3. Explain various forms of business ownership in the accommodations industry; e.g., *individual, chain, franchise, management companies, Real Estate Investment Trusts*
4. Identify the major departments in a large hotel; e.g., *front of the house: front desk, entertainers; back of the house: housekeeping, reservations, maintenance*
5. Describe the range of guest requirements for a variety of travellers; e.g., *business or pleasure traveller, family with special needs, travellers with pets*
6. Describe the impact of technology on the accommodations industry; e.g., *Wifi, Internet access, online bookings*
7. Explain the factors that influence the success of accommodation properties; e.g., *excellence in customer service, location, marketing of property*
8. Identify current trends in the accommodations industry; e.g., *self-service, technology*
9. Describe the impact of technology on distribution channels for branded and independent lodging properties
10. Describe procedures and resources available for dealing with common emergencies, including: *(safety equipment, security personnel, community resources)*
11. Evaluate a sample accommodation business policies pertaining to the safety and security of guests, including: *(confidentiality, security of valuables)*
12. Identify strategies for accommodating special requirements of guests

TOU1060: THE TRAVEL INDUSTRY

Description: Students research a variety of travel services to facilitate travel within Alberta.

Alberta offers a wide range of travel opportunities for tourists and outdoor enthusiasts. From stunning natural landscapes to vibrant cities, here are travel opportunities within Alberta:

- **Banff National Park:** Located in the Canadian Rockies, Banff National Park is one of Canada's most iconic destinations. Visitors can explore breathtaking mountain scenery, crystal-clear lakes, and abundant wildlife. Popular activities include hiking, skiing, snowboarding, and taking a scenic drive along the Icefields Parkway.
- **Jasper National Park:** Another gem in the Canadian Rockies, Jasper National Park offers rugged beauty with glaciers, hot springs, and pristine wilderness. It's an ideal place for outdoor activities such as hiking, wildlife watching, and stargazing.
- **Calgary:** Alberta's largest city, Calgary, is known for its annual Calgary Stampede, a world-famous rodeo and exhibition. Visitors can also explore the city's cultural attractions, dining scene, and outdoor recreational activities like cycling along the Bow River.
- **Edmonton:** Alberta's capital city, Edmonton, boasts a vibrant arts and culture scene. Highlights include the West Edmonton Mall (one of the largest shopping malls in the world), the Royal Alberta Museum, and the historic Old Strathcona district.
- **Lake Louise:** This turquoise glacier-fed lake within Banff National Park is a popular destination for its stunning scenery. Visitors can hike around the lake, take a canoe ride, or simply enjoy the view from the iconic Fairmont Chateau Lake Louise.
- **Drumheller:** Known as the "Dinosaur Capital of the World," Drumheller is famous for its dinosaur fossils and unique badlands terrain. The Royal Tyrrell Museum is a must-visit for dinosaur enthusiasts.
- **Waterton Lakes National Park:** Located in the southwestern corner of Alberta, this park offers picturesque lakes, waterfalls, and a mix of prairie and mountain landscapes. It shares a border with Glacier National Park in Montana, making it a UNESCO World Heritage Site and an International Peace Park.
- **Alberta's Badlands:** Explore the otherworldly landscapes of Alberta's Badlands, which are rich in dinosaur fossils, hoodoos, and unique geological formations. Dinosaur Provincial Park is a UNESCO World Heritage Site and a popular destination.
- **Outdoor Adventures:** Alberta offers numerous opportunities for outdoor enthusiasts, including hiking, biking, fishing, golfing, skiing, and snowboarding. The province's diverse landscapes cater to a wide range of interests and skill levels.

- **Indigenous Cultural Experiences:** Alberta is home to several Indigenous communities that offer cultural experiences and opportunities to learn about the rich history and traditions of the local Indigenous peoples.

Travel for both pleasure and business can be affected by various barriers, which may include:

Travel Restrictions and Entry Requirements: Governments can impose travel restrictions, such as visa requirements, quarantine mandates, or vaccination requirements, which can limit or complicate travel plans.

Health and Safety Concerns: Concerns about health and safety, especially during disease outbreaks (e.g., COVID-19), can deter people from traveling. Fear of illness or exposure to risks can be a significant barrier.

Cost: Travel can be expensive, encompassing expenses like transportation, accommodation, meals, activities, and insurance. High costs may deter individuals from traveling, especially for extended periods.

Time Constraints: Limited time off from work or other commitments can restrict the ability to travel, particularly for extended vacations.

Distance and Accessibility: Long distances, remote locations, or destinations with limited transportation options can make travel challenging and time-consuming.

Language and Cultural Barriers: Language barriers can pose difficulties for travelers, especially when visiting countries where they don't speak the local language. Cultural differences and unfamiliar customs can also be barriers to a smooth travel experience.

Political Instability: Regions with political instability, civil unrest, or ongoing conflicts can be dangerous for travelers, making them hesitant to visit such areas.

Environmental Factors: Natural disasters, extreme weather conditions, or other environmental factors can disrupt travel plans and create safety concerns.

Travel Documentation and Logistics: The process of obtaining passports, visas, and other necessary travel documents can be complex and time-consuming, serving as a barrier for some individuals.

Work and Family Obligations: Commitments at work or family responsibilities can limit the flexibility to travel for both business and leisure.

Lack of Information: Inadequate information or knowledge about a destination, including its culture, customs, and attractions, can be a barrier to planning a trip.

Currency Exchange and Financial Concerns: Managing foreign currencies, exchange rates, and concerns about financial security during travel can discourage potential travelers.

Personal Health and Mobility Issues: Health concerns or mobility issues can limit an individual's ability to travel comfortably or independently.

Legal and Regulatory Barriers: Some destinations have legal restrictions, like prohibitions on certain medications or activities, which can impact travel plans.

Global Events: Global events like pandemics, natural disasters, or political crises can have a profound impact on travel plans and lead to widespread cancellations or postponements.

Insurance Concerns: Concerns about the availability and coverage of travel insurance can affect travelers' confidence in their ability to handle unexpected situations while abroad.

Tourists are attracted to Alberta for a variety of reasons, thanks to its diverse range of attractions and experiences. Here are reasons why tourists might be traveling to and within Alberta:

Natural Beauty: Alberta is renowned for its stunning natural landscapes, including the majestic Canadian Rockies, pristine lakes like Lake Louise and Moraine Lake, and vast expanses of wilderness. The breathtaking scenery attracts nature lovers, photographers, and outdoor enthusiasts.

Adventure Sports: Alberta provides a wide range of adventure sports such as skiing, snowboarding, ice climbing, white-water rafting, mountain biking, and hiking. It's a paradise for adrenaline junkies seeking thrilling experiences.

Wildlife Viewing: Alberta offers abundant wildlife viewing opportunities, with the chance to spot iconic Canadian animals such as grizzly bears, black bears, moose, elk, bighorn sheep, ect.

Indigenous Culture: Tourists interested in Indigenous culture can explore the rich traditions, art, and heritage of Alberta's Indigenous communities. Many Indigenous experiences and cultural events are available throughout the province.

Vibrant Cities: Alberta's cities, including Calgary and Edmonton, offer a blend of cultural attractions, festivals, shopping, dining, and entertainment options. The Calgary Stampede, Edmonton Folk Music Festival, and various arts events draw visitors to these urban centers.

Food and Culinary Experiences: Alberta's culinary scene is gaining recognition, with a focus on locally sourced ingredients, farm-to-table dining, and Alberta beef. Foodies can explore a wide range of restaurants, breweries, and farmers' markets.

Western Heritage: Alberta's cowboy culture and Western heritage are celebrated throughout the province. The Calgary Stampede, ranch experiences, and rodeo events provide a glimpse into this iconic part of Canadian history.

Festivals and Events: Alberta hosts numerous festivals and events year-round, catering to various interests, including music, arts, sports, and culture. These events provide opportunities for cultural immersion and entertainment.

Outdoor Recreation: Whether it's golfing, fishing, kayaking, or horseback riding, Alberta offers a wide range of outdoor recreational activities for visitors of all ages and skill levels.

Alberta offers a wide range of travel services through various agencies and businesses. Here are some key types of travel services and examples of agencies and businesses that provide them:

Travel Agencies:

- **AMA Travel:** The Alberta Motor Association offers travel planning and booking services through their travel division, AMA Travel.
- **Vision Travel:** A full-service travel agency with multiple locations in Alberta, offering vacation packages, cruises, and more.

Airline Companies:

- **Air Canada:** A major Canadian airline with flights to and from cities like Calgary and Edmonton.
- **WestJet:** Another prominent Canadian airline with a significant presence in Alberta.

Hotels and Accommodations:

- **Fairmont Hotels & Resorts:** This luxury hotel chain has properties in Alberta, including the Fairmont Banff Springs and the Fairmont Chateau Lake Louise.
- **Marriott International:** Offers various hotel brands in Alberta, such as Marriott, Sheraton, and Delta Hotels.

Car Rental Agencies:

- **Enterprise Rent-A-Car:** Provides car rental services at multiple locations.
- **Avis Car Rental:** Offers car rental services at airports and cities across Alberta.

Tour Operators:

- **Brewster Travel Canada:** Offers guided tours, activities, and transportation services in the Canadian Rockies, including Banff and Jasper.
- **Sundog Tours:** Provides guided tours and transportation options in Jasper and the surrounding areas.

Travel Insurance Providers:

- **Manulife Financial:** Offers travel insurance coverage for Alberta residents and travelers.
- **Allianz Global Assistance:** Provides travel insurance options for those visiting Alberta or traveling from the province.

Airport Services:

- **Calgary International Airport (YYC):** Offers various services including lounges, ground transportation, and shopping.

- Edmonton International Airport (YEG): Provides passenger services, car rentals, and dining options for travelers.

Transportation Services:

- Calgary Transit: Offers public transportation services within the city of Calgary.
- Edmonton Transit Service (ETS): Provides public transportation options in the city of Edmonton.

Adventure and Outdoor Activities:

- Maligne Adventures: Offers outdoor activities, such as wildlife tours and boat cruises in Jasper National Park.
- Discover Banff Tours: Provides guided tours and activities in the Banff area, including sightseeing tours and hiking trips.

Cruise Lines:

- Rocky Mountaineer: Offers luxury train journeys through the Canadian Rockies, departing from Alberta destinations like Banff and Jasper.

Online Travel Booking Platforms:

- Websites and platforms like Expedia, Booking.com, and Kayak allow travelers to book flights, hotels, and vacation packages for trips to Alberta.

Tourism in Canada is regulated by several government agencies at the federal, provincial, and territorial levels. These agencies play vital roles in overseeing and supporting the tourism industry, which is a significant contributor to the Canadian economy. Roles within the industry:

Destination Canada (formerly the Canadian Tourism Commission): Destination Canada is a federal Crown corporation responsible for promoting tourism in Canada on a national and international scale. Its primary role is to market Canada as a tourism destination, attract international visitors, and support the growth of the tourism industry.

Provincial and Territorial Tourism Ministries/Departments: Each Canadian province and territory has its own tourism ministry or department responsible for developing and implementing tourism policies, strategies, and marketing initiatives within their respective regions. They collaborate with local tourism organizations and stakeholders to promote tourism and support tourism businesses.

Canadian Tourism Human Resource Council (CTHRC): CTHRC focuses on human resource development within the tourism sector. It works to address labor force issues, skills development, and workforce training to ensure that the tourism industry has a skilled and qualified workforce.

Parks Canada: Parks Canada manages and operates national parks, national historic sites, and national marine conservation areas across Canada. These protected areas are significant tourism attractions, and Parks Canada plays a role in preserving their natural and cultural heritage while facilitating tourism-related activities.

Canadian Air Transport Security Authority (CATSA): CATSA is responsible for aviation security in Canada. While not directly a tourism agency, its role in ensuring safe and efficient air travel is essential for the tourism industry, as air transportation is a critical component of travel.

Transport Canada: Transport Canada oversees transportation policies, regulations, and infrastructure, including airports and air travel. It plays a role in ensuring the accessibility and safety of transportation options for tourists.

Canadian Border Services Agency (CBSA): CBSA manages border security and immigration processes at Canadian entry points. It ensures the efficient processing of international visitors, which is vital for tourism.

Destination Marketing Organizations (DMOs): At the local or regional level, DMOs are responsible for promoting specific destinations within Canada. They collaborate with tourism businesses and communities to market and develop their areas as attractive tourist destinations.

Indigenous Tourism Organizations: Indigenous tourism organizations, such as Indigenous Tourism Canada and various provincial Indigenous tourism associations, promote and support Indigenous tourism experiences, ensuring that Indigenous cultures and businesses are integrated into the tourism industry.

Tourism Industry Associations: Various industry associations, such as the Tourism Industry Association of Canada (TIAC) and provincial/territorial tourism associations, advocate for the interests of the tourism sector, provide resources, and facilitate networking among stakeholders.

These agencies and organizations work together to create a favorable environment for tourism growth, promote Canada as a desirable destination, maintain the country's tourism infrastructure, ensure visitor safety, and support the economic and cultural contributions of tourism to Canada's communities and regions.

Analyzing travel opportunities related to market targets involves understanding the specific customer segments, including their geographic, demographic, and psychographic characteristics, and tailoring travel offerings accordingly. Here's an analysis of travel opportunities:

Geographic Market Targets:

Domestic Travelers: Domestic travelers represent a significant market, especially in countries with large populations like the United States or India. These travelers often seek diverse experiences within their own country. Strategies: Promote local attractions, weekend getaways, and road trips. Collaborate with local businesses and tourism boards to create enticing packages for domestic travelers.

International Travelers: International tourists provide an opportunity for destinations to showcase their unique culture, landscapes, and attractions. They contribute to the economy through spending on accommodations, dining, and activities. Strategies: Develop marketing campaigns targeting specific international markets based on their preferences. Simplify visa processes and provide language support for better accessibility.

Demographic Market Targets:

Family Travelers: Families are a significant travel market, often looking for family-friendly accommodations, activities, and destinations. Offer family packages, discounts for children, and provide amenities and services catering to children's needs. Promote safety and convenience.

Millennials and Gen Z Travelers: Younger generations seek unique and Instagram-worthy experiences. They are tech-savvy and value sustainability and authenticity. Embrace technology for seamless bookings and offer adventure, cultural, and eco-friendly travel options. Highlight authentic local experiences.

Baby Boomers and Seniors: Older travelers have more disposable income and may prefer luxury, relaxation, and cultural experiences. Offer senior discounts, accessibility features, and wellness-focused packages. Promote cultural heritage and historical attractions.

Psychographic Market Targets:

Adventure Seekers: Adventure enthusiasts are drawn to activities like hiking, skiing, and water sports. They value thrill and exploration. Promote adventure packages, outdoor gear rentals, and guided tours. Highlight safety measures and experienced guides.

Luxury Travelers: Luxury travelers seek exclusivity, high-end accommodations, fine dining, and personalized services. Offer luxury packages, spa and wellness experiences, gourmet dining, and private tours. Focus on exceptional customer service.

Cultural Explorers: Cultural travelers are interested in art, history, and immersing themselves in local traditions and customs. Highlight cultural festivals, museums, historical sites, and guided heritage tours. Offer language and cultural workshops.

Eco-Conscious Travelers: Travelers who prioritize sustainability seek eco-friendly accommodations, responsible wildlife experiences, and reduced carbon footprints. Implement eco-friendly practices, promote nature conservation, and support eco-certified accommodations and tours.

Wellness and Relaxation Seekers: Wellness travelers prioritize relaxation, spa treatments, yoga retreats, and stress relief. Offer wellness packages, meditation sessions, and tranquil destinations. Highlight serene environments and holistic well-being.

International tourists arriving in Alberta, may encounter various challenges during their visit. These challenges can range from logistical issues to cultural differences. Here are some of the common challenges international tourists might face when arriving in Alberta:

Travel Restrictions and Visa Requirements: International travelers need to meet specific visa and entry requirements to visit Canada. Navigating the visa application process and understanding the entry rules can be challenging.

Language Barriers: Although English is widely spoken in Alberta, tourists who do not speak English may face communication difficulties, especially in more remote areas where language support may be limited.

Currency and Payments: Dealing with a different currency (Canadian Dollar, CAD) and understanding payment methods, including credit cards, debit cards, and cash, can be confusing for international visitors.

Weather and Climate: Alberta experiences a wide range of weather conditions throughout the year, from cold winters to warm summers. International tourists may not be adequately prepared for the climate, leading to discomfort or unexpected challenges.

Transportation: Navigating public transportation or understanding road signs and driving regulations, including driving on the right side of the road, can be challenging for tourists, particularly those from countries with different driving norms.

Accommodation: Finding suitable accommodations within budget and understanding the booking process, including taxes and additional fees, can be challenging for international tourists.

Cultural Differences: Understanding and respecting Canadian customs, social norms, and cultural practices can be challenging for visitors. It's essential for tourists to be aware of cultural sensitivities and etiquette.

Time Zones: Canada spans multiple time zones, and tourists may need to adjust to a new time zone, leading to jet lag or confusion regarding local hours of operation.

Healthcare and Insurance: International tourists should have appropriate health insurance coverage and be aware of the healthcare system in Canada, as medical services can be costly without insurance. Knowing how to access emergency services, such as contacting local law enforcement or healthcare providers, can be essential in case of unexpected incidents.

Internet and Connectivity: International tourists may face challenges related to accessing the internet, obtaining SIM cards, and staying connected during their visit.

Environmental Concerns: Alberta's natural landscapes are pristine, and tourists are expected to follow responsible tourism practices, including proper waste disposal and respecting park regulations.

Retail and Shopping: Understanding Canadian pricing, sales taxes (e.g., GST and PST), and shopping etiquette can be challenging for international shoppers.

Despite these potential challenges, many international tourists have a positive and enriching experience in Alberta by planning ahead, seeking information and assistance, and embracing the diversity and beauty of the region.

To convert distances, speed, temperature, and time while traveling as a tourist, you can use various conversion tools and methods including;

Online Conversion Tools and Apps: Numerous online conversion websites and mobile apps are available for tourists to make quick and accurate conversions on the go. These tools cover various units, including distances, speed, temperature, time, and more.

- **Distance Conversion:** To convert distances between different units (e.g., kilometers to miles or vice versa), you can use conversion formulas or online conversion calculators. For example, to convert kilometers to miles, you can use the formula: $\text{miles} = \text{kilometers} \times 0.621371$.
- **Speed Conversion:** To convert speed between different units (e.g., kilometers per hour (km/h) to miles per hour (mph)), you can use conversion factors. For example, 1 km/h is approximately equal to 0.621371 mph.
- **Temperature Conversion:** To convert temperatures between Celsius ($^{\circ}\text{C}$) and Fahrenheit ($^{\circ}\text{F}$), you can use conversion formulas. For converting Celsius to Fahrenheit, you can use the formula: $^{\circ}\text{F} = (^{\circ}\text{C} \times 9/5) + 32$. For converting Fahrenheit to Celsius, you can use the formula: $^{\circ}\text{C} = (^{\circ}\text{F} - 32) \times 5/9$.
- **Time Zone Conversion:** When traveling across time zones, you'll need to account for time differences. You can use time zone converters or apps to calculate the time difference between your current location and your destination. Be aware of daylight-saving time (DST) changes, as some regions may adjust their clocks seasonally.
- **Time Conversion:** To convert time between different units (e.g., hours to minutes or minutes to seconds), you can use multiplication and division. For example, 1 hour is equal to 60 minutes, and 1 minute is equal to 60 seconds.
- **Currency Conversion (not mentioned but often important for tourists):** To convert currencies, use currency conversion tools or apps, visit currency exchange offices, or check the current exchange rates online. Currency conversion rates can fluctuate, so it's essential to get the most up-to-date rates for accurate conversions.

It's also advisable to check if the country you're visiting uses different units of measurement for things like road signs and weather forecasts and familiarize yourself with local customs and practices related to time and distances.

Required Assignment**/100 Marks**

1. Identify *three* local tourist attractions
2. Categorize the different types of travellers; *e.g., pleasure, family, seniors, bus tours, school groups, seasonal, budget, business*
3. Identify the motivations, needs and expectations of various types of travellers; *e.g., leisure traveller, business traveller, travellers visiting friends and relatives*
4. Describe the travel services provided by: *(travel agencies, tour operators, transportation companies, travel visitor information centres (TVIC), online sources)*
5. Identify current travel industry trends
6. Analyze the impact of technology on the travel industry
7. Identify basic information about Alberta regulations related to: *(fishing, hunting and/or camping, provincial and national parks, liquor, cannabis)*
8. Identify the different modes of transportation and local suppliers of transportation in Alberta and the various services provided
9. Utilizing Google maps, select a tourist location in Alberta and calculate the distance to the destination, length of time to reach the destination, identify amenities close around the destination and insert an image of the map with directions.
10. Using the Travel Alberta website <https://www.travelalberta.com/> explore the ‘**Trip Ideas**’ tab. Then choose the ‘**Road Trips & Itineraries**’ section and find the perfect trip. Pick one multi-day tour package/itinerary for an Alberta attraction. You will then copy the URL address (link) and paste it below with a brief overview describing why you chose this activity.

TOU1070: THE ATTRACTIONS INDUSTRY

Description: Students analyze and compare the natural, cultural and recreational attractions available in Alberta and Canada and develop strategies for maintaining the well-being of guests.

Natural, cultural, and recreational attractions play essential roles in the tourism industry, drawing travelers from around the world to explore and experience new destinations. These attractions contribute significantly to a destination's appeal and economic development. Here's an overview of each type of attraction and their roles in the tourism industry:

Natural Attractions: Natural attractions are the breathtaking landscapes, geological wonders, and ecosystems found in various regions. They showcase the beauty and diversity of the natural world and often form the foundation of many tourist destinations.

Roles in the Tourism Industry:

- **Scenic Beauty:** Natural attractions, such as mountains, waterfalls, beaches, and national parks, offer stunning views and scenic beauty, attracting nature enthusiasts, photographers, and leisure travelers.
- **Outdoor Activities:** These attractions provide opportunities for outdoor activities like hiking, camping, skiing, birdwatching, and wildlife photography. Outdoor enthusiasts and adventure travelers seek out these experiences.
- **Environmental Education:** Natural attractions often serve as outdoor classrooms, educating visitors about ecosystems, biodiversity, and conservation. Interpretive centers and guided tours promote environmental awareness.
- **Wellness and Relaxation:** Many natural attractions, such as hot springs and serene lakes, provide relaxation and wellness opportunities, attracting spa-goers and wellness travelers.
- **Wildlife Watching:** Destinations with diverse ecosystems and wildlife draw wildlife enthusiasts and photographers, generating ecotourism opportunities.

Cultural Attractions: Cultural attractions encompass the historical, artistic, and heritage sites and experiences that showcase a destination's unique cultural identity and history.

Roles in the Tourism Industry:

- **Preservation of Heritage:** Cultural attractions, including museums, historical sites, and monuments, play a vital role in preserving a destination's cultural heritage for future generations.
- **Education and Enrichment:** Tourists visit cultural attractions to learn about local customs, traditions, art, and history. Cultural immersion enhances visitors' understanding of the host culture.
- **Arts and Performances:** Cultural attractions often feature art galleries, theaters, and live performances, promoting local art and culture and supporting the creative arts community.
- **Festivals and Events:** Festivals celebrating music, food, art, and cultural traditions draw visitors and contribute to the local economy.

- **Culinary Experiences:** Food and culinary attractions, including local cuisine and traditional cooking classes, offer unique cultural experiences for tourists interested in gastronomy.

Recreational Attractions: Recreational attractions provide opportunities for leisure, sports, and entertainment, offering a wide range of activities and experiences for tourists.

Roles in the Tourism Industry:

- **Adventure Tourism:** Recreational attractions like zip lines, bungee jumping, and rock climbing cater to adventure seekers, boosting adventure tourism.
- **Sports Tourism:** Sporting events, stadiums, and sports facilities attract sports enthusiasts and fans, driving sports tourism and promoting local sports culture.
- **Gaming and Entertainment:** Casinos, theme parks, and amusement centers offer entertainment and leisure activities, attracting families and tourists seeking entertainment options.
- **Outdoor Recreation:** Recreational attractions, including golf courses, water parks, and ski resorts, create jobs and stimulate the local economy through tourism-related activities.
- **Wellness and Spa:** Wellness centers and spa resorts promote relaxation and health-focused tourism, appealing to those seeking wellness and rejuvenation.

Natural, cultural, and recreational attractions are the cornerstones of the tourism industry, shaping the appeal of destinations and enriching travelers' experiences. They contribute to economic growth, job creation, cultural preservation, and environmental conservation, making them integral components of the global tourism landscape.

The term "**travel generators**" refers to sources or factors that generate or stimulate travel demand within a specific region, city, or area. These generators can be various elements or entities that attract people to travel to a particular destination or create a need for travel. Travel generators can be categorized into different types based on their nature and impact on travel demand. Here are some common examples:

Tourist Attractions: Natural wonders, cultural sites, historical landmarks, museums, amusement parks, and other attractions can serve as significant travel generators. These points of interest draw visitors from different locations, leading to increased travel to the area.

Events and Festivals: Special events, festivals, concerts, sporting events, and conventions can generate a surge in travel demand. Attendees often travel to the event's location, contributing to the local tourism industry.

Business and Conventions: Corporate meetings, conferences, trade shows, and business-related events create travel demand for business travelers. Cities with a strong business sector often serve as travel generators for corporate travelers.

Educational Institutions: Cities or regions with universities, colleges, and schools attract students, faculty, and researchers, leading to travel for educational purposes. Academic institutions can be significant travel generators.

Medical Tourism: Areas with renowned medical facilities and healthcare services attract patients from other regions or countries, generating travel for medical treatment and healthcare.

Transportation Hubs: Major airports, bus terminals, train stations, and ports can be travel generators as they serve as gateways for travelers arriving or departing from a specific area. These hubs can stimulate both business and leisure travel.

Natural Resources: Areas rich in natural resources, such as mining, agriculture, or forestry regions, often generate travel related to resource extraction or agricultural activities.

Government and Administrative Centers: Capital cities and government administrative centers attract government officials, diplomats, and individuals involved in political or administrative affairs, leading to travel demand.

Religious Pilgrimage Sites: Cities or locations with religious significance attract pilgrims and religious tourists, generating travel for spiritual and religious purposes.

Entertainment and Sports: Entertainment hubs, including theaters, cinemas, and sports stadiums, can generate travel when they host popular shows, movies, or sports events.

Evaluating the effectiveness of an attraction in meeting the needs and expectations of visitors is a crucial aspect of destination management and tourism development. A successful attraction should not only attract visitors but also provide a positive and satisfying experience. Key steps:

- **Visitor Feedback and Surveys:** Collect feedback from visitors through surveys, comment cards, or online reviews. Ask about their overall experience, what they liked, and what could be improved.
- **Visitor Numbers and Trends:** Analyze visitor statistics over time, including the number of visitors, repeat visits, and seasonal trends. Sudden drops or stagnation in visitor numbers can indicate issues.
- **Visitor Demographics:** Understand the demographics of your visitors. Are you attracting the target audience? If not, adjustments may be needed in marketing or the attraction itself.
- **Customer Reviews and Ratings:** Monitor online review platforms like TripAdvisor, Yelp, or Google Reviews to gauge visitor sentiment. High ratings and positive reviews often indicate satisfaction.
- **Visitor Behavior Analysis:** Analyze visitor behavior, such as time spent at the attraction, repeat visits, and interactions with exhibits or activities. This can reveal how engaging and appealing the attraction is.

- **Complaints and Concerns:** Address and analyze visitor complaints and concerns promptly. Common issues can provide insights into areas that need improvement.
- **Competitor Comparison:** Compare your attraction with similar attractions in the region or industry. Assess your strengths and weaknesses relative to the competition.
- **Maintenance and Upkeep:** Regularly assess the physical condition of the attraction. Poor maintenance can negatively impact the visitor experience.
- **Accessibility and Amenities:** Ensure that the attraction is accessible to individuals with disabilities and provides essential amenities like restrooms, dining options, and information centers.
- **Safety and Security:** Evaluate safety measures and visitor security. Visitors should feel safe during their visit, and any potential safety concerns must be addressed.
- **Educational and Interpretive Value:** Assess the educational and interpretive value of the attraction. Does it provide informative and engaging content? Are there interactive elements that enhance the learning experience?
- **Sustainability and Environmental Practices:** Evaluate the attraction's sustainability efforts and environmental practices. Many visitors appreciate eco-friendly and responsible tourism initiatives.
- **Innovation and Updates:** Regularly introduce new exhibits, activities, or features to keep the attraction fresh and encourage repeat visits.
- **Staff Training and Service:** Evaluate the quality of customer service provided by staff. Training programs can help improve visitor interactions and satisfaction.
- **Marketing Effectiveness:** Assess the effectiveness of marketing efforts in promoting the attraction. Monitor conversion rates and return on investment (ROI) for marketing.
- **Financial Performance:** Review the financial performance of the attraction, including revenue, profitability, and cost-effectiveness. High operating costs relative to revenue may indicate inefficiencies.
- **Community and Stakeholder Engagement:** Engage with the local community and stakeholders to gather input and address any concerns or impacts related to the attraction's operations.

In attraction facilities, ensuring excellent guest services is vital to providing visitors with a positive and memorable experience. Depending on the size and type of the attraction, various departments or employees may be responsible for guest services. Here are key departments and roles typically involved in guest services at attraction facilities:



Guest Services Department: This department is often dedicated solely to guest services and acts as a central point of contact for visitors. It handles inquiries, complaints, information dissemination, and general assistance.

Front Desk or Reception: Front desk staff or receptionists are often the first point of contact for guests. They provide information, answer questions, handle check-ins, distribute maps or brochures, and assist with ticketing.

Concierge: Concierge staff are knowledgeable about the local area and can assist guests with restaurant reservations, transportation arrangements, and recommendations for activities or services outside the attraction.

Ticketing and Box Office: Ticketing and box office employees sell admission tickets, process payments, and manage entry into the attraction. They play a crucial role in ensuring a smooth entry process.

Visitor Services Representatives: Visitor services representatives are stationed throughout the attraction to assist guests, answer questions, provide directions, and offer general assistance.

Security and Safety Personnel: Security and safety personnel are responsible for ensuring the safety and well-being of guests. They handle emergencies, enforce safety protocols, and may provide first-aid assistance.

Tour Guides and Educators: For attractions offering guided tours or educational programs, tour guides and educators lead groups of visitors, provide information, and enhance the learning experience.

Retail and Gift Shop Staff: Retail and gift shop employees assist visitors with purchases, offer product knowledge, and may process returns or exchanges.

Food and Beverage Staff: Staff working in restaurants, cafes, or food concessions within the attraction are responsible for providing food and beverage services to guests.

Housekeeping and Maintenance: Housekeeping and maintenance teams ensure that facilities, restrooms, and public areas are clean, well-maintained, and safe for guests.

Audiovisual and Technology Support: Attractions with multimedia exhibits or technology-based attractions may have technicians or support staff to assist with audiovisual equipment and interactive displays.

Accessibility Services: Some attractions have staff dedicated to assisting guests with disabilities or special needs, ensuring accessibility and a comfortable experience for all visitors.

Event and Group Coordinators: For attractions that host events, weddings, or group tours, event and group coordinators work with organizers to plan and execute special activities or occasions.

Marketing and Public Relations: The marketing and public relations teams promote the attraction, handle media inquiries, and manage social media platforms to engage with guests and the public.

Management and Leadership: Overall responsibility for guest services often rests with attraction management and leadership, who set service standards, make strategic decisions, and oversee staff training and development.

Employees play a crucial role in providing guest services in various industries, including hospitality, tourism, retail, and entertainment. Their interactions with customers can significantly impact the overall guest experience. Here are key roles of employees in providing guest services:

- **Welcome and Greeting:** Employees are often the first point of contact with guests. A warm and friendly welcome sets a positive tone for the guest's visit. This includes greeting guests with a smile, making eye contact, and offering a friendly verbal welcome.
- **Information and Assistance:** Employees should be knowledgeable about the products, services, or attractions offered and be able to provide accurate and helpful information to guests. This includes answering questions, giving directions, and explaining policies or procedures.
- **Effective Communication:** Clear and effective communication is vital. Employees should listen actively to guests' inquiries or concerns and provide responses in a polite and respectful manner. They should also communicate any relevant information or updates.
- **Problem Resolution:** When guests encounter issues or concerns, employees should be prepared to address them promptly and effectively. This may involve finding solutions, escalating issues as needed, and ensuring guest satisfaction.
- **Personalized Service:** Providing personalized service involves recognizing and addressing individual guest preferences or needs. Employees can enhance the guest experience by offering personalized recommendations or recognizing returning guests.
- **Courtesy and Respect:** Employees should treat all guests with courtesy and respect, regardless of their background, appearance, or requests. Being attentive and courteous fosters a welcoming atmosphere.
- **Efficiency and Promptness:** Efficient and prompt service is essential. Guests appreciate quick responses, timely assistance, and minimal waiting times. Employees should prioritize efficiency without compromising quality.
- **Safety and Security:** In industries like hospitality and tourism, ensuring guest safety and security is paramount. Employees should be trained in safety procedures, emergency response, and incident reporting.

- **Conflict Resolution:** Occasionally, employees may need to manage conflicts or difficult situations. Effective conflict resolution skills, such as remaining calm, empathizing, and finding mutually agreeable solutions, are essential.
- **Upselling and Cross-Selling:** In retail and hospitality, employees may have the opportunity to upsell or cross-sell additional products or services to enhance the guest's experience. They should do so in a helpful and non-pushy manner.
- **Maintaining Cleanliness and Order:** In settings like hotels, restaurants, and attractions, employees contribute to the guest experience by ensuring cleanliness, orderliness, and a well-maintained environment.
- **Professional Appearance:** Employees should maintain a professional appearance by adhering to dress code and grooming standards. A neat and tidy appearance contributes to a positive impression.
- **Continuous Training and Development:** Employees should be provided with ongoing training and opportunities for professional development to stay updated on best practices and industry trends.
- **Positive Attitude:** A positive and enthusiastic attitude is contagious and can enhance the overall guest experience. Employees who are genuinely interested in helping guests have a memorable visit contribute significantly to guest satisfaction.

Ultimately, employees are the face of a business or organization and can leave a lasting impression on guests. Their commitment to providing excellent guest services can lead to customer loyalty, positive reviews, and the overall success of the business.

Required Assignment**/100 Marks**

1. Describe the role *attractions, special events and festivals* play in the tourism industry
2. Analyze the appeal of **natural attractions** to visitors by:
 - outlining the historical development of Canada's national parks, identifying Alberta's natural attractions on a map
 - reviewing the role of national parks in preserving the environment
 - describing strategies used to manage visitor impact in parks
 - identifying the global appeal of natural attractions in Alberta and Canada
 - describing the range of visitor activities and services provided in natural attractions
3. Analyze the appeal of **cultural attractions** by identifying one major cultural attraction, describing the range of visitor activities and services provided
4. Evaluate the appeal of **recreational attractions** to visitors by describing one provincial recreational attraction
5. Outline recent visitor trends related to natural, cultural and recreational attractions
6. Identify procedures and strategies for maintaining the well-being of guests in local attraction facilities
7. Evaluate the range of visitor activities and services provided at a local attraction facility and identify strategies implemented for the maintenance of the attraction; *e.g., preventing overcrowding, ecological damage*
8. Using the Travel Alberta website <https://www.travelalberta.com/> explore the '**Trip Ideas**' tab. Then choose the '**Road Trips & Itineraries**' section and find the perfect trip. Pick one multi-day tour package/itinerary for an Alberta attraction, that is different than you previously examined. You will then copy the URL address (link) and paste it below with a brief overview describing why you chose this activity.

TOU1910: TOU PROJECT A

Description: Students develop project design and management skills to extend and enhance competencies and skills in other CTS courses through contexts that are personally relevant.

Required Assignment**/100 Marks**

Go to the official website of Travel Alberta <https://www.travelalberta.com/>

Explore the site links ‘**Places to Go**’ or ‘**Things to Do**’

Select **one** Alberta destination, event, attraction or activity listed from **EACH** of the two tabs (‘**Places to Go**’ or ‘**Things to Do**’). You will then copy the URL address (link) and paste it below with a brief overview of each describing why you chose this destination, event, attraction or activity.

TOU2010: EVENT MANAGEMENT

Description: Students plan, organize, facilitate and evaluate a tourism event in the school or community.

A well-developed business plan is essential for hosting a tourist event for several reasons:

Clarity of Purpose: A business plan helps define the event's objectives, goals, and purpose. It outlines the reasons for hosting the event, whether it's to promote tourism, showcase a destination, celebrate a cultural festival, or achieve specific economic or community development objectives.

Strategic Planning: It provides a strategic roadmap for organizing and executing the event, including timelines, budgets, and key milestones. A well-structured plan ensures that all necessary tasks are identified and completed in a coordinated manner.

Financial Planning: Business plans outline the financial aspects of the event, including budgeting, revenue projections, and funding sources. This financial clarity helps secure funding from stakeholders, sponsors, and investors.

Risk Management: A comprehensive business plan includes risk assessments and contingency plans to address potential challenges, such as adverse weather, logistical issues, or unexpected emergencies. This proactive approach minimizes disruptions during the event.

Resource Allocation: It helps allocate resources effectively, including human resources, materials, equipment, and marketing expenditures. This ensures that resources are utilized efficiently and that there is no wastage.

Marketing and Promotion: The plan outlines the event's marketing and promotional strategies, target audience, and channels. Effective marketing is critical to attract tourists and generate buzz about the event, leading to increased attendance.

Stakeholder Engagement: Business plans identify and engage relevant stakeholders, such as local businesses, government agencies, tourism boards, and community organizations. Collaboration and support from stakeholders can enhance the event's success.

Measurable Goals and Objectives: The plan establishes measurable criteria for success, allowing organizers to track progress and evaluate the event's impact. This data-driven approach enables adjustments and improvements for future events.

Sustainability and Legacy: Sustainable practices and legacy considerations are increasingly important in event planning. A well-developed plan can incorporate eco-friendly initiatives and leave a positive legacy for the host community.

Legal and Regulatory Compliance: Business plans ensure that the event complies with all relevant laws, permits, and regulations. Failure to do so can lead to legal issues and disruptions.

Community and Cultural Considerations: Cultural sensitivity and community engagement are critical, especially for events that involve local traditions or heritage. The plan can outline strategies to respect and involve the host community.

Evaluation and Learning: Post-event evaluation is crucial for learning from successes and challenges. A business plan may include post-event assessments to gather feedback and insights for future planning.

Professionalism and Credibility: Having a good business plan lends professionalism and credibility to the event organizers. It instills confidence in sponsors, participants, and attendees.

Long-Term Sustainability: A business plan can outline strategies for the event's long-term sustainability and growth. This may include recommendations for evolving the event, expanding its reach, or creating spin-off events.

Evaluating a tourist event involves assessing its performance, identifying strengths and weaknesses, and gathering data for future improvements. Establishing a reporting and monitoring process, as well as event policies and procedures, is invaluable for this evaluation process. Here's why these elements are crucial:

Reporting and Monitoring Process:

- **Real-Time Assessment:** A reporting and monitoring process allows for real-time assessment during the event. Organizers can track attendance, revenue, logistical issues,

and visitor feedback as the event unfolds, enabling immediate adjustments and improvements.

- **Data Collection:** It facilitates data collection through surveys, feedback forms, observations, and metrics. This data provides valuable insights into visitor satisfaction, preferences, and behaviors.
- **Performance Metrics:** Establishing key performance indicators (KPIs) helps organizers measure the event's success against predefined goals. KPIs may include attendance numbers, revenue generated, visitor demographics, and social media engagement.
- **Quality Control:** Monitoring processes help identify any deviations from the planned schedule or event policies. This allows for quick intervention to ensure that the event maintains its quality and integrity.
- **Issue Resolution:** With a monitoring process in place, issues and challenges can be identified and addressed promptly. This minimizes disruptions and enhances the overall guest experience.
- **Feedback Loop:** It creates a feedback loop with stakeholders, including event staff, volunteers, sponsors, vendors, and visitors. This open communication channel helps gather diverse perspectives and allows for continuous improvement.
- **Risk Mitigation:** Monitoring can help identify potential risks or safety concerns early, enabling organizers to take preventive measures or implement emergency response plans as needed.
- **Budget Control:** By tracking expenditures and revenue in real-time, organizers can manage the event budget more effectively, ensuring that financial goals are met.

Establishing Event Policies and Procedures:

- **Consistency:** Event policies and procedures ensure consistency in the execution of tasks and operations. This consistency contributes to a smooth and predictable event experience for visitors.
- **Safety and Security:** Clear policies and procedures promote safety and security for both visitors and staff. They outline emergency protocols, crowd management strategies, and health and safety measures.
- **Guest Experience:** Policies related to guest services, such as admission, accessibility, and conduct, contribute to a positive and welcoming guest experience. Visitors appreciate knowing what to expect and how they should behave.
- **Vendor and Sponsor Relations:** Event policies can govern vendor and sponsor relationships, ensuring that all parties understand their roles, responsibilities, and expectations.

- **Legal Compliance:** Event policies help organizers adhere to legal and regulatory requirements. This includes permits, licenses, insurance, and compliance with local ordinances.
- **Conflict Resolution:** Procedures for addressing disputes or conflicts among staff, visitors, or stakeholders can help maintain a harmonious environment and minimize disruptions.
- **Resource Allocation:** Policies guide resource allocation, including staff assignments, equipment usage, and space management. Efficient resource allocation contributes to cost-effectiveness.
- **Communication:** Having procedures in place for communication and decision-making ensures that relevant information reaches the right individuals or teams promptly. This is crucial for addressing issues and making informed decisions.
- **Accountability:** Policies and procedures establish accountability among event staff and stakeholders. They clarify roles and responsibilities, reducing the likelihood of misunderstandings or omissions.

Developing a budget and establishing financial controls and procedures for hosting an event require a set of financial management skills and competencies. Here are key tasks:

Budgeting Skills: **Budget Development:** The ability to create a comprehensive budget that includes all anticipated income and expenses for the event. This includes forecasting revenues, estimating costs, and defining financial goals.

Financial Forecasting: **Revenue Projections:** The skill to forecast various revenue streams accurately, such as ticket sales, sponsorships, merchandise, and concessions. **Expense Estimation:** The capability to estimate expenses, including venue costs, marketing expenses, personnel costs, permits, and other event-related expenditures.

Cost Control: **Expense Monitoring:** Monitoring and tracking expenses throughout the event's planning and execution phases to ensure they stay within budget. **Cost Reduction:** Identifying cost-saving opportunities without compromising the event's quality or objectives.

Financial Analysis: **Financial Ratios:** Understanding and using financial ratios (e.g., ROI, profit margin) to assess the event's financial performance and make informed decisions.

Financial Documentation: **Record Keeping:** Effective record-keeping skills to maintain organized and accurate financial documents, such as receipts, invoices, and financial statements. **Documentation Management:** Ensuring that all financial transactions are documented and archived properly for auditing and reporting purposes.



Cash Flow Management: Cash Flow Projection: The ability to project cash flow needs and ensure that there is sufficient liquidity to cover expenses as they arise. Cash Handling: Proper handling and safeguarding of cash and payments received during the event.

Financial Controls: Internal Controls: Establishing and maintaining internal controls and safeguards to prevent fraud, errors, and financial mismanagement. Approval Processes: Implementing approval processes for expenses and purchases to ensure compliance with budgetary guidelines.

Financial Reporting: Financial Statements: Preparing financial statements, including income statements, balance sheets, and cash flow statements, to summarize the event's financial performance. Variance Analysis: Analyzing budget variances to identify discrepancies and take corrective actions as needed.

Risk Management: Risk Assessment: Identifying financial risks associated with the event and developing risk mitigation strategies. Insurance Management: Managing insurance coverage to protect against unforeseen financial liabilities or losses.

Negotiation Skills: Vendor Negotiation: Negotiating contracts and agreements with vendors, suppliers, and service providers to secure favorable terms and pricing.

Financial Compliance: Regulatory Knowledge: Staying informed about relevant financial regulations, tax laws, and reporting requirements applicable to events and ensuring compliance.

Team Collaboration: Cross-functional Collaboration: Collaborating with other event management teams (e.g., marketing, operations) to align financial plans with overall event objectives.

Adaptability: Adaptive Financial Planning: Being adaptable and able to adjust the budget and financial strategies in response to changing circumstances or unforeseen challenges.

Problem Solving: Financial Troubleshooting: The ability to identify financial problems or discrepancies and develop solutions to address them efficiently.

Communication Skills: Effective Communication: Communicating financial information and updates clearly and concisely to stakeholders, sponsors, and team members.

Developing financial resources for an event involves identifying and securing the funds needed to plan, organize, and execute the event successfully. Here are steps for your event:

Set Budget: Define the event's objectives, goals, and scope. Create a detailed budget outlining all expected expenses and projected revenues. This serves as a financial roadmap.

Identify Funding Sources: Determine where your event's funding will come from. Consider a mix of sources:

- Self-Financing: Use existing funds, reserves, or profits from previous events.

- Sponsorships: Seek corporate sponsors or partners willing to invest in your event in exchange for brand visibility and promotional opportunities.
- Ticket Sales: Generate revenue by selling tickets or admissions to the event.
- Grants and Funding Programs: Explore government grants, foundations, or funding programs that support events related to your event's theme or goals.
- Donations and Crowdfunding: Encourage individual donations through crowdfunding platforms or seek contributions from philanthropic organizations.
- Vendor Fees: Charge vendors or exhibitors a fee for participating in the event.
- Merchandise Sales: Sell event-related merchandise, branded apparel, souvenirs, or products.

Sponsorship Acquisition:

- Create a compelling sponsorship proposal outlining the benefits sponsors will receive in return for their support, such as brand exposure, advertising opportunities, and exclusive access to the event audience.
- Identify potential sponsors whose target audience aligns with your event's demographic.
- Approach sponsors with your proposal, and be prepared to negotiate terms and benefits.

Ticket Sales and Registrations:

- Set ticket prices based on your budget and target audience's willingness to pay.
- Implement an effective ticketing system that allows for online ticket sales, registration, and secure payment processing.

Grants and Funding Applications:

- Research and identify relevant grants, funding programs, or local government initiatives that may support your event.
- Prepare grant applications or proposals, ensuring they align with the criteria and objectives of the funding sources.

Donation Campaigns:

- Launch donation campaigns to solicit contributions from individuals, organizations, or businesses.
- Utilize online platforms and social media to raise awareness about your event and its funding needs.

Vendor and Exhibitor Fees:

- Determine fees for vendors or exhibitors participating in your event.
- Promote the benefits of participation, such as access to a specific audience or potential sales opportunities.

Merchandise Sales:

- Design and produce event merchandise that appeals to attendees.
- Set up merchandise stalls or online store to sell branded items before and during event.



Advance Ticket Sales: Encourage early ticket purchases by offering discounts or special perks for early bird registrants.

Payment Plans and Options: Offer flexible payment options, such as installment plans or group discounts, to make attendance more accessible to a wider audience.

Financial Partnerships: Explore financial partnerships with banks, credit unions, or financial institutions that may offer event financing or support.

Track and Manage Finances: Implement financial management tools and software to track income and expenses, manage budgets, and ensure financial transparency.

Evaluate and Adjust: Continuously monitor your event's financial status and adjust your financial strategy as needed to meet your goals and stay within budget.

Sourcing suppliers and negotiating contracts for an event is a critical aspect of event planning and management. Effective supplier selection and contract negotiation can impact the event's success, budget, and overall guest experience. Here's a step-by-step guide for an event:

Define Your Event Requirements: Clearly define your event's needs, including the type of products or services required, quantities, quality standards, and any specific preferences.

Research Potential Suppliers: Conduct research to identify potential suppliers who can meet your requirements. Sources for finding suppliers include:

- Online directories and platforms (e.g., Alibaba, Thomasnet, EventSupplier).
- Recommendations from industry peers and colleagues.
- Local business associations and trade shows.
- Industry-specific publications and websites.

Create a Supplier Shortlist: Evaluate potential suppliers based on factors such as their reputation, experience, reliability, pricing, location, and the suitability of their products or services for your event.

Request for Proposals (RFPs): Prepare a Request for Proposal (RFP) document outlining your event's requirements, expectations, and evaluation criteria. Send the RFP to the selected suppliers, inviting them to submit detailed proposals.

Review Proposals: Evaluate the received proposals, paying attention to pricing, product/service specifications, delivery timelines, references, and any additional value-added services offered.

Negotiate Terms and Conditions: Initiate negotiations with selected suppliers to finalize terms and conditions. Key negotiation points may include:

- Pricing: Negotiate pricing to ensure it aligns with your budget.
- Payment Terms: Establish payment schedules, terms, and methods.
- Delivery and Lead Times: Define delivery schedules and lead times to meet event.

- **Quality Assurance:** Discuss quality standards, specifications, and potential penalties for non-compliance.
- **Insurance and Liability:** Clarify insurance requirements and liability in case of accidents or damages.
- **Cancellation and Termination:** Outline cancellation policies and procedures.
- **Additional Services:** Determine any additional services or support required from the supplier.
- **Compliance:** Ensure that the supplier complies with all legal and regulatory requirements.
- **Dispute Resolution:** Specify mechanisms for resolving disputes or conflicts.

References: Ask potential suppliers for references or testimonials from previous clients to gauge their track record and reliability.

Perform Due Diligence: Verify the supplier's credentials, reputation, and financial stability, especially if you are entering into a long-term or significant contract.

Contract Drafting and Review:

- Draft a detailed contract that incorporates all negotiated terms and conditions, as well as any legal requirements.
- Review the contract with your legal counsel to ensure it is legally sound and protects your interests.

Developing a marketing plan and strategies for an event is crucial for generating interest, increasing attendance, and ensuring its success. Here's a step-by-step guide on how to create an effective marketing plan for your event:

Define Your Event's Goals and Objectives: Clearly state the goals and objectives of your event. These could include increasing attendance, generating revenue, enhancing brand awareness, or promoting a cause.

Understand Your Target Audience: Identify your event's target audience. Consider demographics, interests, behaviors, and preferences. Create detailed buyer personas to guide your marketing efforts.

Determine Your Budget: Allocate a budget for your marketing efforts. This budget should cover advertising, promotional materials, online marketing, and any other marketing expenses.

Choose Marketing Channels and Tactics: Select the marketing channels and tactics that align with your goals and audience. Common marketing channels and tactics for events include:

- **Digital Marketing:** Website and landing pages, Email marketing, Social media marketing, Online advertising (Google Ads, Facebook Ads), Search engine optimization (SEO), Content marketing (blog posts, articles, videos)
- **Traditional Marketing:** Print materials (flyers, posters, banners), Direct mail, Public relations and media outreach, Radio or TV advertising (if applicable)
- **Event-Specific Marketing:** Event listings on websites and event directories, Event partnerships and collaborations, Promotional offers and discounts, Referral programs

- **Word-of-Mouth and Networking:** Encourage attendees and partners to spread the word, Leverage your network for promotion
- **Event Website and Registration Page:** Create a user-friendly event website with essential information, registration forms, and a secure payment gateway.
- **Content Marketing:** Develop engaging and informative content related to your event, including blog posts, videos, and infographics.

Develop a Content Plan: Create a content plan that outlines the type of content, publishing schedule, and distribution channels. Ensure that your content resonates with your target audience and aligns with your event's messaging.

Establish a Social Media Strategy: Leverage social media platforms to promote your event. Develop a social media content calendar, engage with your audience, and use relevant hashtags and trends to increase visibility.

Create Compelling Visuals and Materials: Design eye-catching visuals, including event logos, posters, banners, and digital assets, to create a strong visual identity for your event.

Implement Email Marketing: Build an email list of potential attendees and send personalized and engaging email campaigns. Use email automation to send reminders, updates, and offers.

Monitor and Measure: Implement tracking tools (Google Analytics, social media analytics, email marketing analytics) to measure the performance of your marketing efforts. Monitor metrics such as website traffic, conversion rates, social engagement, and ticket sales.

Implement Paid Advertising: If budget allows, consider using paid advertising channels such as Google Ads, Facebook Ads, or sponsored content on relevant platforms.

Engage with Influencers and Partners: Collaborate with influencers, industry experts, and event partners to expand your reach and credibility.

Implement a Registration and Ticketing System: Use a user-friendly registration and ticketing system on your event website to facilitate seamless attendee registration and payment processing.

Execute a Post-Event Follow-Up: After the event, send thank-you emails, gather feedback, and share highlights and photos to maintain engagement and encourage attendance at future events.

The purpose of a risk management plan for an event is to identify, assess, mitigate, and effectively manage potential risks and uncertainties associated with the event. It serves as a comprehensive strategy for safeguarding the event's success, reputation, finances, and the safety and well-being of all stakeholders. Here are the primary purposes of a risk management plan:

- **Risk Identification:** Identify all possible risks and uncertainties that could impact the event, including internal and external factors. These risks may range from logistical challenges and budgetary issues to safety concerns and legal liabilities.

- **Risk Assessment:** Evaluate the likelihood and potential impact of each identified risk. By assessing risks, you can prioritize them based on their significance and likelihood of occurrence.
- **Prevention and Mitigation:** Develop strategies and measures to prevent or minimize identified risks. This includes implementing proactive measures to reduce the likelihood of risks occurring or to mitigate their impact if they do occur.
- **Contingency Planning:** Establish contingency plans for handling unexpected or high-impact risks. Contingency plans outline the steps to take when specific risks materialize, ensuring a swift and effective response.
- **Resource Allocation:** Allocate resources (financial, human, and logistical) to address and manage risks effectively. This includes budgeting for risk mitigation measures and emergency responses.
- **Legal and Regulatory Compliance:** Ensure that the event complies with all relevant laws, regulations, permits, and safety standards. Failure to comply with legal requirements can lead to legal issues and disruptions.
- **Safety and Security:** Prioritize the safety and security of all event participants, including attendees, staff, volunteers, and performers. This includes planning for medical emergencies, crowd control, and evacuation procedures.
- **Financial Protection:** Protect the event's financial assets by addressing financial risks, such as budget overruns, revenue shortfalls, and unexpected expenses.
- **Reputation Management:** Safeguard the event's reputation by addressing risks related to public relations, negative media coverage, or actions that may damage the event's image.
- **Communication Planning:** Develop a communication plan to inform stakeholders about potential risks, safety measures, and contingency plans. Effective communication can reduce panic and confusion in case of emergencies.
- **Vendor and Supplier Risk:** Assess and manage risks associated with vendors and suppliers, including reliability, contract adherence, and quality of products or services.
- **Environmental Considerations:** Consider environmental risks and implement sustainability practices to minimize the event's impact on the environment.
- **Documentation and Reporting:** Maintain comprehensive documentation of risk assessments, mitigation strategies, and incident reports. This documentation can be invaluable for post-event evaluations and audits.

The purpose of a human resource (HR) plan, often referred to as a human resource management plan, is to effectively manage an organization's workforce to achieve its strategic goals and

objectives. This plan outlines how the organization will acquire, develop, manage, and retain its human capital to support its mission and long-term success. Human resource plan:

Aligning HR with Business Goals: The HR plan ensures that HR strategies and initiatives are closely aligned with the overall strategic goals and objectives of the organization. It helps bridge the gap between the organization's mission and its workforce requirements.

Workforce Planning: It outlines the organization's short-term and long-term workforce needs, including the number of employees, skills, and competencies required to meet business objectives.

Talent Acquisition: The plan defines strategies for attracting and recruiting top talent. This includes identifying sources of talent, developing job descriptions, conducting interviews, and implementing onboarding processes.

Skills Development and Training: It identifies the training and development needs of employees to enhance their skills, knowledge, and capabilities. Training programs can help employees grow in their roles and contribute to the organization's success.

Performance Management: The plan establishes processes for setting performance expectations, providing feedback, conducting evaluations, and recognizing and rewarding high-performing employees. Effective performance management contributes to employee motivation and productivity.

Compensation and Benefits: The HR plan includes strategies for determining competitive compensation packages, benefits, and incentives to attract and retain employees.

Compliance and Legal Requirements: It ensures that HR practices comply with labor laws, regulations, and ethical standards, reducing legal risks and potential liabilities.

Cost Control and Budgeting: The plan helps manage HR-related costs effectively, ensuring that the organization's resources are allocated efficiently and that budget constraints are met.

A human resource plan serves as a roadmap for an organization to effectively manage its most valuable asset—its people. By aligning HR strategies with business objectives and focusing on talent acquisition, development, engagement, and retention, the plan helps organizations build a skilled, motivated, and adaptable workforce that can contribute to long-term success.

Required Assignment

/100 Marks

1. List a range of local events available; *e.g., mega-events, hallmark events, special events*
2. Outline various categories of events; *e.g., public, private, business, educational, arts*
3. Identify the potential areas involved in hosting an event and an event management plan
4. Explain the importance of employee professionalism, demonstrating leadership, and ability to solve problems as it relates to hosting an event
5. Using the Explore Edmonton website <https://exploreedmonton.com/> review the ‘**Things to Do**’ tab. Then select from **two** different categories. Pick one activity, event, attraction, or experience from two different categories. You will then copy the URL address (link) and paste it below with a brief overview describing why you chose this activity, event, attraction, or experience.

TOU2060: TRAVEL DESTINATIONS 1

Description: Students demonstrate knowledge of world tourism and geography by presenting travel information about North America and at least one other world region.

Cultural Geography refers to the branch of geography that focuses on the study of how culture, including beliefs, traditions, customs, values, languages, and social practices, interacts with and influences the spatial aspects of the physical world. It examines the relationship between human culture and the environment in which it exists, including how culture shapes the landscape and how the landscape, in turn, influences culture.

When it comes to tourism, cultural geography plays a significant role in understanding how the culture of a region influences and shapes the tourism industry. Here's the impact tourism:

Attractions and Activities: The cultural heritage of a region often forms the basis for tourist attractions and activities. Historical sites, museums, festivals, and cultural events draw tourists who are interested in experiencing the unique traditions and history of a place. For example, the cultural heritage of a city like Rome is a major draw for tourists who visit iconic sites like the Colosseum and the Vatican.

Cuisine and Culinary Tourism: The cuisine and culinary traditions of a region can be a significant driver of tourism. Food tourism is increasingly popular, with travelers seeking authentic culinary experiences. Local dishes, street food, and traditional cooking classes attract food enthusiasts who want to taste and learn about the local culture through its cuisine.

Arts and Entertainment: Cultural geography plays a role in the development of the arts and entertainment sectors within tourism. The presence of theaters, music venues, art galleries, and cultural performances can enhance a destination's appeal to tourists interested in the arts.

Language and Communication: Language is a vital aspect of culture, and it directly impacts the tourism industry. A region's dominant language(s) can influence the ability of tourists to communicate with locals, navigate the area, and engage in cultural exchanges. Multilingual guides and interpretation services may be essential for ensuring a positive tourist experience.

Accommodations and Hospitality: The culture of a region can influence the design and style of accommodations, as well as the level of hospitality and service provided to tourists. Different cultures have varying hospitality norms and expectations, and this can shape the quality and character of lodging options.

Local Traditions and Customs: Tourists often seek to engage with local traditions and customs when they visit a new destination. This may involve participating in rituals, festivals, or ceremonies that are integral to the cultural identity of the region. For instance, tourists in Japan often participate in tea ceremonies and wear traditional kimono to immerse in local culture.

Impact on Marketing and Promotion: Cultural elements are frequently incorporated into tourism marketing campaigns. Promotion may emphasize a region's unique cultural offerings, showcase its distinctiveness and inviting travelers to explore and experience the local life.

Cultural Preservation and Sustainability: Tourism can have both positive and negative impacts on local culture. Cultural geography helps identify ways to preserve and protect cultural heritage while ensuring the sustainability of tourism. Balancing the economic benefits of tourism with cultural preservation is a critical consideration for destination management.

Travel patterns in the world are influenced by a variety of factors, including economic, technological, social, political, and environmental variables. These factors shape how people travel, where they go, and why they choose specific destinations. Here are some key travel patterns and the influences behind them:

- **Business Travel:** Business travel patterns are heavily influenced by economic activities, global trade, and corporate interests. The need for face-to-face meetings, conferences, and negotiations drives business travelers to destinations worldwide.
- **Leisure Travel:** Leisure travel patterns are shaped by disposable income, lifestyle choices, and the desire for relaxation, adventure, or cultural experiences. Social media, travel trends, and recommendations from friends and family also impact leisure travel decisions.
- **Seasonal Travel:** Seasonal travel patterns are influenced by weather conditions and holidays. Many travelers prefer to visit destinations during specific seasons, such as beach destinations in summer or ski resorts in winter.
- **Urban and Rural Travel:** Urbanization and economic opportunities in cities influence migration and commuting patterns. People often move to urban areas for employment, education, and cultural amenities.
- **Adventure and Ecotourism:** Increasing awareness of environmental issues and a desire for authentic and sustainable experiences drive adventure and ecotourism. Travelers seek destinations with natural beauty, wildlife, and opportunities for outdoor activities.
- **Cultural and Heritage Tourism:** Interest in cultural heritage, historical sites, and indigenous traditions encourages cultural tourism. Government initiatives, preservation efforts, and tourism promotion play roles in attracting visitors to such destinations.
- **Medical Tourism:** Access to affordable healthcare, specialized medical treatments, and cosmetic procedures influence medical tourism. Cost disparities between countries and advancements in medical technology drive this pattern.
- **Visiting Friends and Relatives (VFR):** Travel to visit friends and relatives is often motivated by family ties, social obligations, or cultural traditions. Diaspora communities and immigration patterns contribute to VFR travel.

- **Transportation Infrastructure:** The availability, affordability, and efficiency of transportation modes (e.g., air, rail, road, sea) impact travel patterns. Improved transportation infrastructure can open up new destinations to tourists.
- **Political Stability and Safety:** Political stability, safety concerns, and travel advisories can significantly affect travel patterns. Destinations with political turmoil or security issues may experience a decline in tourism.
- **Technological Advances:** Technological innovations, such as online booking platforms, mobile apps, and GPS navigation, have transformed travel. Travelers now have greater access to information, convenience, and personalized experiences.
- **Economic Development:** The level of economic development in a region affects both inbound and outbound tourism. As economies grow, people have more disposable income for travel.
- **Global Events and Trends:** Global events like the Olympics, World Expos, and major sporting events can drive tourism to specific destinations. Emerging travel trends, such as wellness tourism or digital nomadism, shape travel patterns.
- **Environmental Concerns:** Environmental awareness and concerns about climate change influence travel patterns. Sustainable eco-friendly travel choices are becoming popular.
- **Crisis and Pandemics:** Unexpected events, such as natural disasters, health crises (e.g., COVID-19), or geopolitical conflicts, can disrupt travel patterns. Travel restrictions and safety concerns can deter travel to certain regions.

Tourism can have significant impacts on a host nation, encompassing financial, cultural, and environmental aspects. While tourism can bring economic benefits, cultural exchange, and increased awareness of a destination, it can also pose challenges and negative consequences. Here's an overview of the impact of tourism on host nations in these three dimensions:

Financial Impact:

Economic Growth: Tourism can stimulate economic growth by generating revenue through various channels, including accommodation, food services, transportation, and attractions. This revenue can contribute to job creation, increased tax revenues, and improved infrastructure.

Foreign Exchange Earnings: Tourism often brings in foreign exchange earnings, which can bolster a host nation's balance of payments and strengthen its currency. This is particularly important for countries heavily dependent on tourism.

Diversification of the Economy: Tourism can help diversify an economy by reducing dependence on a single industry. This diversification can enhance a nation's resilience to economic downturns in other sectors.

Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs): Tourism provides opportunities for local SMEs to thrive, offering goods and services to tourists and contributing to entrepreneurship.

Challenges: However, the financial impact of tourism can be unevenly distributed, with some areas benefiting more than others. There may also be issues related to leakage, where a significant portion of tourism revenue leaves the host nation, primarily going to international tour operators or large multinational corporations.

Cultural Impact:

Cultural Exchange: Tourism facilitates cultural exchange by exposing visitors to the host nation's traditions, heritage, customs, and way of life. It can promote intercultural understanding and appreciation.

Preservation and Promotion: Tourism can encourage the preservation and promotion of cultural heritage sites, traditional crafts, and indigenous practices, as they become economically valuable assets.

Cultural Dilution: However, the influx of tourists can sometimes lead to the dilution or commodification of cultural traditions, where they are adapted for commercial purposes and lose their authenticity.

Overcrowding and Cultural Erosion: Excessive tourism can put immense pressure on cultural sites and communities. Overcrowding, vandalism, and insensitive behavior by tourists can lead to the erosion of local culture and traditions.

Environmental Impact:

Conservation and Protection: Tourism can contribute to the conservation and protection of natural areas and wildlife through funding generated by national parks and eco-tourism.

Awareness and Advocacy: Tourists who visit ecologically sensitive areas often become advocates for environmental conservation after experiencing these environments firsthand.

Negative Environmental Impact: However, tourism can also have negative environmental consequences, including habitat disruption, pollution, resource depletion, and carbon emissions from transportation.

Over tourism: Popular tourist destinations can suffer from over tourism, leading to overcrowding, environmental degradation, and strain on resources.

Host nations must carefully manage and balance the financial, cultural, and environmental impacts of tourism to maximize the benefits while minimizing the negative consequences. Sustainable tourism practices, community engagement, and responsible tourism development are essential strategies to achieve this balance and ensure that tourism is a positive force for host nations.

Required Assignment

/100 Marks

1. Define basic geography terms: *Latitude, longitude, meridians, hemisphere, continents*
2. Describe characteristics of major geographic regions and locate the major geographical regions on a world map (insert an image with them labeled)
3. Describe the characteristics of the following five major climatic regions and locate these major climatic regions on a world map (insert an image with them labeled): *Tropical, Dry, Temperate, Continental, Polar*
4. Find and insert a world map image of the major climatic regions labeled
5. Find and insert a world map image that has the continents and major bodies of water five labeled
6. Find and insert a world map image that locates: *Central America and the Caribbean, South America, Europe, Eastern Europe, Mediterranean and the Middle East, Africa, Asia, East Asia, Australia, South Pacific*
7. Identify one major tourism destination or attraction in the following regions: *Central America and the Caribbean, South America, Europe, Eastern Europe, Mediterranean and the Middle East, Africa, Asia, East Asia, Australia, South Pacific*
8. Using a travel related search engine, (Expedia, Travelocity, Trivago, Tripadvisor) locate a *multi-day travel itinerary package* for a *North American destination*. It should include all transportation, accommodation, hospitality, other costs, attractions, duration, and any other details of the trip destination. You will then copy the URL address (link) to the destination package or insert a image of the information requested and paste it below with a brief overview describing why you chose this destination.

TOU2070: TRAVEL DESTINATIONS 2

Description: Students demonstrate knowledge of world tourism and geography by presenting travel information regarding various tourism regions of the world.

The appeal of tourism regions is shaped by a blend of natural, cultural, political, and economic factors. These features not only define the character of a destination but also heavily influence its attractiveness to tourists. Let's explore these aspects in more detail:

Climate: The climate of a region is a fundamental attractor for tourists. For instance, warm and sunny climates are ideal for beach vacations, while cooler climates attract those interested in winter sports or unique experiences like aurora viewing.

Landforms: The geography of a region, including its mountains, rivers, beaches, and forests, plays a significant role in tourism. Mountainous areas are popular for activities like hiking and skiing, and coastal regions are sought after for water-based recreation.

Culture: The cultural heritage of a region, encompassing its history, art, music, and traditions, is a major draw for tourists. This can include everything from historical sites and museums to cultural festivals and performances.

Political System: The political stability and policies of a region can influence its tourism industry. Regions that are politically stable and have tourist-friendly policies tend to attract more visitors.

Economic Development: The level of economic development affects the tourism infrastructure, such as the quality of hotels, restaurants, and transport systems, which in turn impacts tourists.

Several other elements significantly influence tourism in these regions:

- **Food:** Local gastronomy is a key aspect of the tourism experience. Many tourists are drawn to destinations specifically to explore the local cuisine, which can offer a unique insight into the region's culture and traditions.
- **Events:** Special events such as festivals, sports competitions, and concerts can draw significant tourist numbers. These events offer unique experiences that are often deeply rooted in the local culture.
- **Attractions:** Specific attractions like natural wonders, theme parks, historic landmarks, and unique local businesses are major draws. They often serve as the primary motivation for tourists to visit a region.
- **Customs:** The customs and daily life practices of a region can be fascinating to tourists. Engaging with local customs and traditions allows tourists to immerse themselves in the region's culture, offering a deeper and more authentic travel experience.

Exploring major tourist attractions and regions reveals a fascinating array of destinations across the globe, each offering unique experiences and attractions.

Machu Picchu, Peru: Known for its historical and archaeological significance, Machu Picchu is offering new ways to explore its lesser-known sides, including the Quarry Trail which features the Perolnuyoc Cascade waterfall and ancient Inca ruins.

Martha's Vineyard, Massachusetts: Celebrate the 50th anniversary of the book "Jaws" by touring the filming locations on Martha's Vineyard. The island is also known for its New England beauty, including the clay cliffs of Aquinnah and the historic carousel in Oak Bluffs.

National Geographic's Picks: National Geographic highlights destinations like the Albanian Alps, the Andrefana Dry Forests in Madagascar, Valletta in Malta, Pompeii in Italy, and the Yucatán Peninsula in Mexico. Notably, Wales is recognized for its centuries-old whisky tradition.

Lonely Planet's Recommendations: The "Best in Travel" list includes Spain for its sustainability efforts, Patagonia for rewilding projects, the Midwest of the US for value, Nairobi, Paris, and Jakarta for cities to visit, and Mongolia, Chile, and Croatia for countries to explore. The Western Balkans' Trans Dinarica Cycling Route and South Australia's Kangaroo Island are among the best regions.

Booking.com's Top Destinations: According to Booking.com, top destinations include Cairns, Australia, known for the Great Barrier Reef and Daintree Rainforest; Panglao, Philippines, famous for its blue waters and white sand beaches; Rotorua, New Zealand, known for geothermal attractions; and Chemnitz, Germany.

Netherlands: For those seeking a winter vacation, the Netherlands offers beautiful national parks like Hoge Veluwe and the Wadden Sea. It's also an excellent destination for cycling enthusiasts.

Each of these destinations offers a unique blend of natural beauty, cultural richness, and historical significance, making them ideal for a variety of travel interests and preferences. Whether you're interested in exploring ancient ruins, enjoying scenic landscapes, or immersing yourself in local culture and traditions, these destinations have much to offer for travelers.

Required Assignment

/100 Marks

1. Search and list the top **ten** World's most popular tourism destinations or regions
2. Summarize **two** different and unique tourist attractions from outside North America
3. Using a travel related search engine, (Expedia, Travelocity, Trivago, Tripadvisor, Bookings.com) locate a multi-day travel itinerary package for **three** possible world destinations.
 - They may have varying travel options (cruise, backpack trip, resorts, physical attraction).
 - Each should include travel information for each destination, including:
(attractions, accommodations, transportation requirements, currency, language, climate (temperature), culture and customs, food, telephone code, other important travel information)
 - You will then copy the URL address (link) to the destination package or insert a image of the information requested and paste it below with a brief overview describing why you chose this destination.

TOU2080: TRAVEL PLANNING

Description: Students create and evaluate an Alberta or Canada tour package and/or an international travel package, including itinerary, tour and attractions information, and traveller information.

Travel planning activities encompass a wide range of options, catering to various preferences, time constraints, and interests. These can range from short, self-guided day trips to extended, fully escorted group tours. Here's a breakdown of the spectrum of travel planning activities:

Day Trips:

- These are short excursions typically lasting a single day.
- They often involve visiting nearby attractions or engaging in specific activities like hiking, city tours, or visiting museums.
- Day trips are usually self-guided, but guided options are available.

Weekend Getaways:

- Ideal for those looking to escape for a couple of days.
- Can include road trips, short city breaks, or countryside retreats.
- Accommodations might range from hotels to bed-and-breakfasts or camping.

Self-Guided Tours:

- Travelers plan their itinerary, transportation, accommodations, and activities.
- Flexibility to tailor the trip according to personal interests and pace.
- Popular for exploring a particular region or following themed routes, like culinary trails or historical landmarks.

Package Holidays:

- These trips typically include transportation, accommodations, and sometimes meals.
- Offer convenience and value, often with a set itinerary.
- Popular for beach vacations, resort stays, or thematic experiences like cruises.

Escorted Group Tours:

- These are organized tours with a set itinerary led by a tour guide.
- Include transportation, accommodations, some meals, and guided sightseeing.
- Ideal for those who prefer a structured schedule and enjoy socializing with fellow travelers.

Adventure or Special Interest Tours:

- Focus on specific activities like trekking, wildlife safaris, or cultural immersion.
- Can be guided or semi-guided.
- Often tailored to niche interests or hobbies.

Long-term Travel or Gap Year Trips:

- Extended travel plans, often spanning several months.

- Can be a mix of volunteering, working abroad, and leisure travel.
- Popular among students or those seeking a sabbatical.

Luxury Travel:

- High-end travel experiences with premium accommodations, exclusive access, and personalized services.
- Often includes private tours, luxury cruises, or bespoke itineraries.

Travel agencies in Alberta provide a diverse range of travel planning services, catering to different types of travelers and their unique needs. Here's how to offer these services:

Adventure Life: Specializes in adventure and nature-based tours. They offer itineraries that include hiking in the Canadian Rockies, exploring national parks like Banff and Yoho, and adventurous expeditions to remote areas like Canada's Arctic and the Northwest Passage. These services cater to travelers looking for active, nature-focused experiences and unique adventures in less-traveled regions.

The Travel Lady Agency: Based in Calgary, this agency offers customized travel experiences around the world. They provide a wide range of travel options, including guided trips, ocean and river cruises, and unique travel escapes to various destinations. Their services are tailored to travelers seeking personalized itineraries and those interested in exploring different parts of the world, whether it's for leisure, adventure, or cultural experiences.

Canadian Travel Agents Platform: This platform features several travel agents each with their own specialties, such as luxury travel, all-inclusive vacations, destination weddings, and escorted tours. Agents like Rick MacSwain and Laurie Ross offer expertise in areas like African safaris and leisure group travel. This service is ideal for travelers looking for specialized travel experiences or needing expert guidance in specific travel niches.

Marlin Travel: With multiple locations in Alberta, Marlin Travel offers comprehensive travel services including vacation planning, flight bookings, cruises, car rentals, and tours & activities. They also specialize in destination weddings and group travel. Their services are suited for travelers who prefer a one-stop-shop experience for all their travel needs, from transportation to accommodation and activities.

When it comes to traveling to or from Canada, there are specific limitations and requirements regarding documentation, criminal records, and traveling with children.

Documentation Requirements:

For Canadian residents returning to Canada, the primary required document is a valid Canadian passport. This is universally accepted and proves your right to return to Canada. Other documents that may be used include a NEXUS card, FAST card, Canadian emergency travel document, Canadian temporary passport, Certificate of Canadian citizenship, Enhanced driver's license, or Enhanced identification/photo card issued by a Canadian province or territory. Permanent residents should carry proof of permanent residence along with their passport. For entry into Canada, international visitors must carry acceptable identification and a valid visa if

necessary. A passport is recommended as the most reliable and universally accepted travel document.

Traveling with Children:

When traveling with a minor, it's recommended to carry copies of any legal custody documents. If you're not the parent or legal guardian, or if you share custody and the other guardian isn't traveling with you, it's advisable to carry a consent letter from the custodial parents or legal guardians. This letter should include their full name, address, and telephone number. Having this letter notarized can help to support its authenticity and avoid delays.

Travelers with Criminal Records:

Travelers with a criminal record may face challenges entering Canada. The Canadian government can deny entry to individuals with criminal records, depending on the crime, its severity, and how long ago it occurred. It's advisable to consult with Canadian immigration services or a legal expert to assess individual cases and understand the potential impact on travel.

Electronic Travel Authorization (eTA):

Visa-exempt foreign nationals, except U.S. citizens, need an eTA to fly to or transit through Canada. This should be applied for before booking your flight to Canada. Canadian citizens, including dual citizens, and Canadian permanent residents are exempt from this requirement.

These requirements emphasize the importance of carrying the correct documentation and understanding the legal implications of your travel, especially when it comes to criminal records or traveling with minors. For the most accurate and detailed information, it's always best to consult the official Canadian government travel websites or contact relevant authorities directly.

<https://travel.gc.ca/travelling/documents>

<https://www.cbsa-asfc.gc.ca/travel-voyage/td-dv-eng.html>

<https://travel.gc.ca/returning/entry-requirements>

In Canada, several agencies provide comprehensive travel health and safety information for both Canadian residents and international travelers. These include:

Travel.gc.ca: This website is a valuable resource for Canadian travelers. It offers detailed health and safety information, including travel health notices, safety and security advice outside Canada, and specific guidance for different types of travelers such as dual citizens, women, older people, and 2SLGBTQI+ individuals. The site also provides policies, acts, regulations, and various forms like the consent letter for children traveling abroad.

Public Health Agency of Canada: This agency provides Travel Health Notices, outlining potential health risks to Canadian travelers and recommending ways to reduce them. It also includes information on Yellow Fever Vaccination Centres, travel health and safety tips, and resources for travel health professionals. The Committee to Advise on Tropical Medicine and Travel (CATMAT) under this agency offers travel health-related advice and statements.

Canadian Consular Services: In case of a medical emergency abroad, Canadian consular officials can provide assistance such as a list of local registered physicians and health care facilities, help in identifying medical care options, and assistance with medical evacuations. However, they cannot pay medical bills or provide medical or legal advice. Consular services are available at more than 260 offices worldwide and offer 24-hour assistance.

They provide up-to-date information and practical tips to ensure a safe and healthy travel experience.

<https://travel.gc.ca/travelling/health-safety>
<http://www.travel.gc.ca/travelling/publications/well-on-your-way>
<https://www.canada.ca/en/public-health/services/travel-health.php>

Travel Advisories:

The Government of Canada provides travel advice and advisories through its official website, Travel.gc.ca. These advisories offer crucial information to help Canadians make informed decisions and stay safe while traveling abroad. The advisories are regularly updated to reflect the changing safety and security conditions in different countries. Travelers are encouraged to check the page for their specific destination frequently for the latest updates and guidelines. For more detailed information on Canadian travel advisories, <https://travel.gc.ca/travelling/advisories>

Travel Insurance:

Canadian travel insurance is a type of insurance designed to cover risks associated with traveling, both domestically and internationally. It typically includes coverage for medical emergencies, trip cancellations or interruptions, lost or stolen luggage, and other unforeseen travel-related incidents. The extent of coverage, terms, and costs vary based on the insurance provider and the specific policy chosen. Travelers are advised to review and understand their insurance policies to ensure adequate coverage for their travel needs.

When planning a tour, a travel planner considers various factors to ensure the trip meets the client's preferences and needs. These factors include:

- Age: Tailoring activities and accommodations suit the age group, such as more leisurely activities for older travelers or more energetic adventures for younger ones.
- Needs: Accommodating any special needs, like wheelchair access or dietary restrictions.
- Desired Activities: Aligning activities with the client's interests and physical abilities.
- Budget: Planning a trip that stays within the client's financial constraints.
- Season of the Year: Considering the weather and seasonal events at the destination.
- Time and Distance: Managing the duration of the trip and distances between destinations.
- Accommodation: Selecting suitable lodging based on comfort, location, and amenities.
- Attractions: Choosing attractions that align with the client's interests.
- Geography: Understanding the geographical layout to plan efficient routes.
- Risk Assessment: Evaluating safety and health risks, including travel advisories.
- Mode of Transportation: Deciding on the most suitable means of travel, flying, driving, or cruising.
- Language: Considering language barriers and whether guides or translators are needed.
- Currency: Preparing for currency exchanges and advising on spending.

- Food Preferences: Taking into account dietary preferences or restrictions.

Each of these factors plays a crucial role in ensuring a well-planned, enjoyable, and safe trip that is tailored to the client's individual preferences and requirements. An itinerary typically includes:

- Dates and Times: Specific dates and times for each activity, departures and arrivals.
- Destinations: Places to be visited with detailed addresses or locations.
- Transportation Details: Information on flights, trains, buses, car rentals, or other modes of transport, including timing and booking references.
- Accommodation Information: Details of hotels or other lodging, including check-in and check-out times.
- Scheduled Activities: Planned tours, events, meetings, or other activities with timing and locations.
- Meal Plans: Information on included meals or recommended dining options.
- Emergency Contacts: Contact details for emergencies, including local services and embassy information.
- Travel Documents: Reminders about travel documents like passports, visas, or tickets.
- Health and Safety Information: Advice on health precautions, vaccinations, or safety tips relevant to the destination.
- Local Information: Currency, language, cultural norms, and other relevant local details.
- Free Time: Unstructured periods for relaxation or personal exploration.

Flight Insurance:

- Advantages: Covers unexpected events like flight cancellations, delays, and missed connections. Offers peace of mind, especially for costly or long-haul flights.
- Disadvantages: May be redundant if your credit card or other policies already cover these risks. Specific conditions may apply, limiting the payout.

Accident or Health Insurance:

- Advantages: Essential for medical emergencies abroad. Covers hospital bills, emergency services, and sometimes medical evacuation.
- Disadvantages: Pre-existing conditions might not be covered. There could be high deductibles and coverage limits.

Baggage and Personal Possession Insurance:

- Advantages: Covers loss, theft, or damage to luggage and personal items. Useful for expensive electronics or valuables.
- Disadvantages: May have limits on claim amounts and not cover all items. Sometimes secondary to homeowner's insurance.

Trip Cancellation Insurance:

- Advantages: Reimburses non-refundable costs if you need to cancel or cut short your trip due to emergencies.
- Disadvantages: Only covers specific, listed reasons for cancellation. Pre-existing conditions or changing your mind aren't usually covered.

1. Define the following travel related terms: (*domestic, international travel, inbound, outbound, free independent traveller (FIT), group travel*)
2. List the advantages and disadvantages of commercial travel planning and tour packages
3. Summarize the different types of travel plans and tours available to the traveller, including: (*trip itineraries, day trips, site tours, inclusive tour charters resorts, special interest travel*)
4. Identify the importance of immunizations as required for specific travel according to: <https://travel.gc.ca/travelling/health-safety/vaccines>
5. Summarize factors that influence customer satisfaction and strategies travel planners use to ensure customer satisfaction
6. Identify the importance of travel reviews to evaluate travel plans and tours
7. Using a travel related search engine, (Expedia, Travelocity, Trivago, Tripadvisor, Bookings.com) select an existing multi-day destination travel package and choose an appropriate one to meet the needs of either a family or a school group. You will then copy the URL address (link) to the destination package or insert an image of the information requested and paste it below with a brief overview describing why you chose this destination.

TOU2910: TOU PROJECT B & TOU2920: TOU PROJECT C

Description: Students develop project design and management skills to extend and enhance competencies and skills in other CTS courses through contexts that are personally relevant.

Using the Travel Destination Canada website <https://travel.destinationcanada.com/en-ca>

Explore the ‘Places to go’, ‘Things to do’ or ‘Travel packages’ tab. Then choose a location, activity, attraction, or event and find the perfect trip that is meaningful to you. Select **three different** tourist attractions, events, locations, or activities. You will then copy the three URL addresses (links) and paste them below with overview describing why you chose that activity.

Activity #1:

Activity #2:

Activity #3:

CTS Assessment Rubric

Knowledge & Understanding: Demonstrates understanding of concepts, terminology, and processes related to the module. Applies knowledge accurately in practical and theoretical tasks.

Skills & Application: Demonstrates technical skills and competencies required for the module. Applies skills effectively to complete tasks, projects, or problem-solving situations.

Communication & Professionalism: Communicates clearly (oral, written, or digital as appropriate). Demonstrates responsibility, organization, safety, and professional conduct in work.

Creativity & Initiative: Demonstrates innovation, problem-solving, and adaptability in approaching tasks. Shows initiative, independence, and perseverance in completing module outcomes.

1. Knowledge & Understanding

- Excellent (5): Demonstrates thorough and insightful understanding of concepts, terminology, and processes; consistently applies knowledge with accuracy and depth.
- Proficient (4): Demonstrates solid understanding of concepts and processes; applies knowledge accurately with minor errors.
- Acceptable (3): Demonstrates basic understanding of key concepts and processes; applies knowledge with occasional inaccuracies or gaps.
- Limited (1–2): Demonstrates minimal understanding of concepts and processes; frequent inaccuracies or lack of application.

2. Skills & Application

- Excellent (5): Consistently demonstrates strong technical skills; work is accurate, efficient, and exceeds module expectations.
- Proficient (4): Demonstrates competent technical skills; work is generally accurate and meets module expectations.
- Acceptable (3): Demonstrates developing technical skills; work is partially accurate and inconsistently meets expectations.
- Limited (1–2): Demonstrates limited technical skills; work is incomplete, inaccurate, or rarely meets expectations.

3. Communication & Professionalism

- Excellent (5): Consistently communicates clearly and effectively in multiple formats; demonstrates professionalism, organization, and responsibility at all times.

- Proficient (4): Communicates effectively in most situations; generally demonstrates professionalism and responsibility.
- Acceptable (3): Communicates ideas with some clarity; professionalism and responsibility are inconsistent.
- Limited (1–2): Communication is unclear or incomplete; demonstrates limited professionalism or responsibility.

4. Creativity & Initiative

- Excellent (5): Consistently demonstrates innovation, problem-solving, and independence; takes initiative to extend learning beyond expectations.
- Proficient (4): Demonstrates creativity and initiative; solves problems with some support and extends learning at times.
- Acceptable (3): Demonstrates some creativity and initiative; relies on support to solve problems and meet outcomes.
- Limited (1–2): Demonstrates little creativity or initiative; rarely attempts problem-solving independently.

Assessment Total:	/20 points x5	/100 marks
Knowledge & Understanding	_____	
Skills & Application	_____	
Communication & Professionalism	_____	
Creativity & Initiative	_____	

Each category may be tailored to the specific context of the CTS course. This rubric provides a balanced approach to assess students' skills and competencies in a comprehensive manner.

Comments: